

Site 63: 19-17/84/1

ES-S AHL (2)

Israel grid: 1989/1747

UTM grid: 7373/5617

Elevation: 25● m b.s.l., 2● m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosures

Area: 2 dunams (2●●● sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

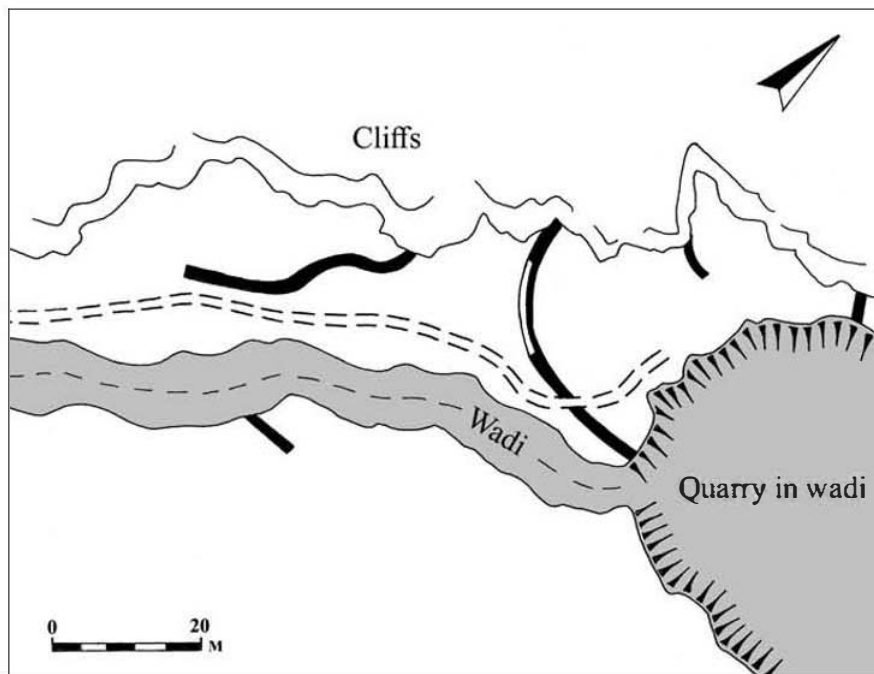
Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
3 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B1●),
8●● m distant

Visit: Feb. 2●●2; 4● sherds

This is a small and rather ruined site in the border of the cliff line and the Jordan Valley, about 6●● m south-south-west of the centre of Argaman. The site is about 2●● m south-west of the sharp curve of the road ascending to Argaman, and slightly south of the Umm Kharubeh (1) site. The site has been damaged by tractors, by the deep ravine, and by the quarrying of riverbed material.



125. Plan of es-Sahl (2), 2003.

Along the low cliff edge were found the remains of two enclosures, including walls made of large stones adjacent to the cliff in the east. The southern enclosure includes an irregular wall, bulldozed and cut at its southern end. Part of this wall is east of the deep ravine cutting the site.

The major part of the northern enclosure has been destroyed by the quarry and the riverbed. Originally there was a large enclosure wall with two rows of large stones about 40 m in diameter, attached to the cliff.

Pottery: Iron I – 25%; Iron II – 20%; Late Roman – 40%; Middle Ages – 15%.

Flint: 10 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 64: 19-17/84/2

ES-SAHL (1)

Israel grid: 1986/1746

UTM grid: 7371/5616

Elevation: 250 m b.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosures and structures

Area: 12 dunams (1.2 ha)

Topography: valley margins and plain

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: palms

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
3.3 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
600 m distant

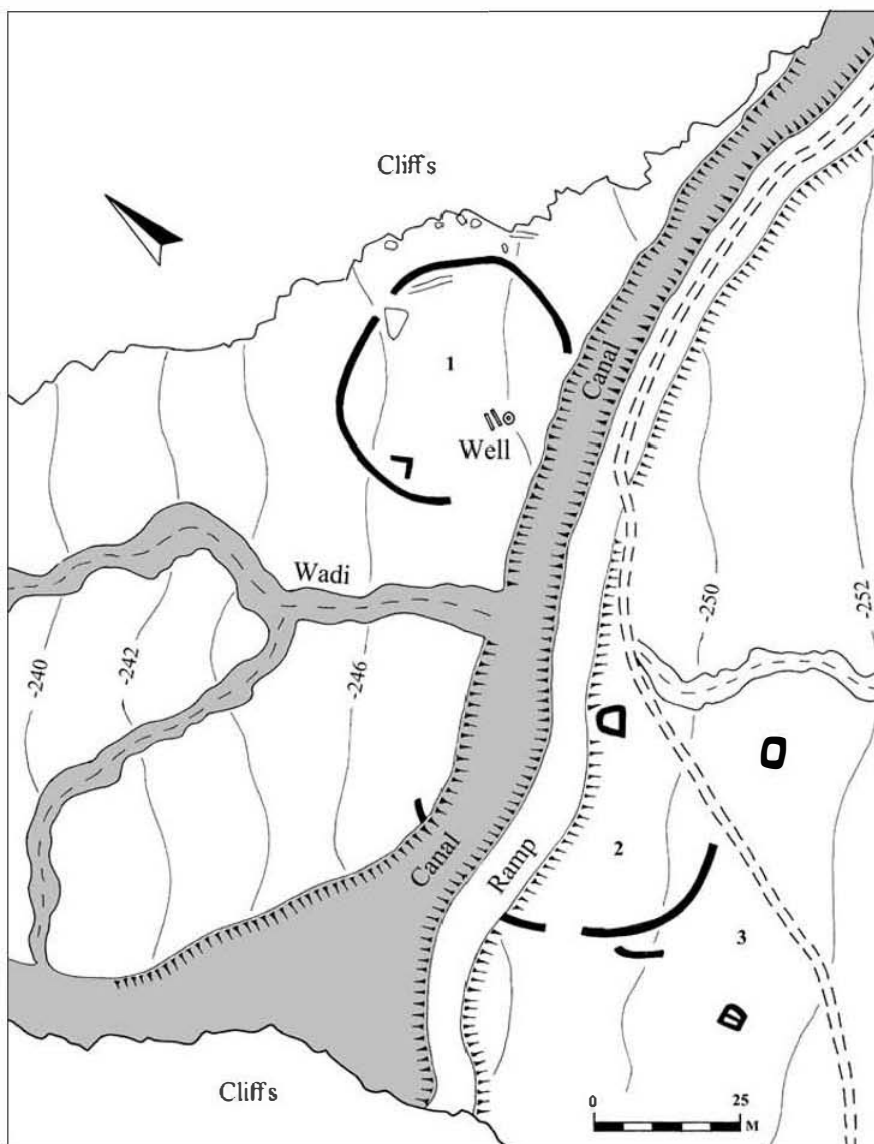
Visit: Feb. 2002; 50 sherds

A large and dispersed site in the floodplain of one of the tributaries of Wadi Umm Kharubeh, where the main wadi empties into the Jordan Valley plain. The site is slightly north of Bedhat esh-Sha'ab (Site 65). The small gully formed by the delta has been blocked by a flood-prevention dike, which badly damaged the sites.

There are three main parts to the site, spread over both sides of the tributary valley:

1. Northern enclosure: Diameter about 35 m; practically intact except for its southern part, destroyed by tractors. The enclosure wall is built of double rows of medium-sized stones, and in its southern part is a well, which might be ancient, but next to it is a concrete facility, on which a pump motor was installed. Inside the enclosure were some construction remains and sherds.

2. Southern enclosure: Between the high flood prevention dike and the new dirt road crossing the area from north to south. Remains of an oval enclosure, built with one or two rows of large stones, in the style of the nearby IA I enclosures. Only about 50 m of the wall survived.
3. Other structures: Next to the southern enclosure: three structures, built of large stones, measuring 5×4 m on average, with walls built very similarly to the walls in the southern enclosure.

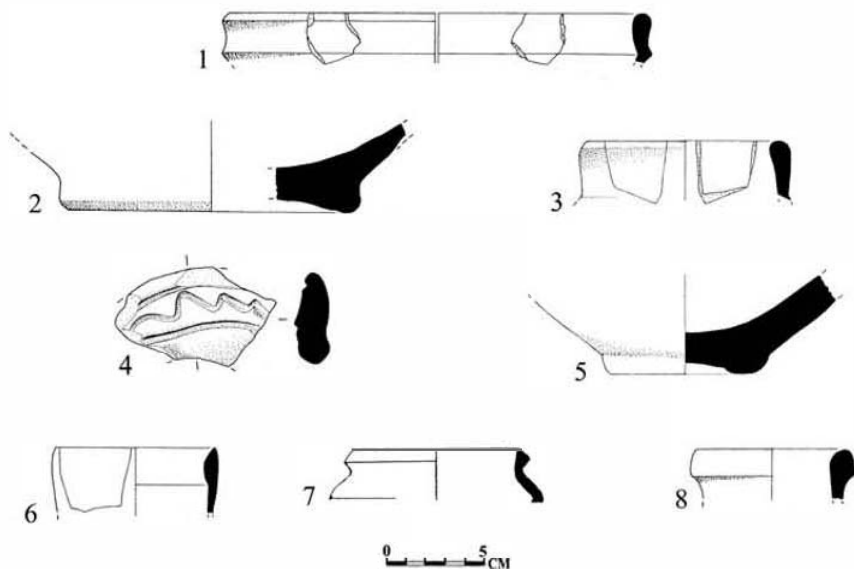


126. Plan of es-Sahl (1), 2002.

Due to the strong resemblance between the construction of the southern enclosure and that of Bedhat esh-Sha'ab, it is possible that there was a link



127. Es-Sahl (1), view to the north-west. The person to the left of the jeep is standing by the remains of the IA I enclosure walls (S. Hashman).



128. Pottery from es-Sahl (1): 1, 7. CPs, dk brn, Ir I; 2, 5. Bases of large bowls, buff, Ir I-II; 3. Jar, brn, Ir II; 4. Bowl, cream, plastic dec, MA; 6. Jar, gr, MA; 8. Jar, lt brn, LR.

between them. A small number of IA I sherds was found in the southern enclosure.

Pottery: In the southern enclosure - Iron I – 100%. In the northern enclosure - Iron II – 60%; Late Roman – 30%; Middle Ages – 10%.

Flint: 4 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 65: 19-17/84/4

BEDHAT ESH-SHA'AB

Israel grid: 1985/1742

UTM grid: 7369/5612

Elevation: 240 m b.s.l., 60 m b.s.a.

Name: ancient, but not on map

Site type: enclosure

Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Water source: River Jordan (112),
3.5 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
500 m distant

Visits: Nov. 1989, May 2001 and many
more, 2002–2003 – excavations;
263 sherds

This is a large enclosure in an inner valley at the western margins of the Jordan Valley, about 1.5 km south-south-west of Argaman. South of it on a hill is Argaman's new water reservoir.

Two one-week excavation seasons were conducted at the site, in February 2002 and in February 2003; see Appendix B.

The site is a sandal-shaped enclosure, measuring roughly 170×90 m. Its longer north-western side, is adjacent to a rocky slope descending from Umm Kharubeh ridge to the Jordan Valley.

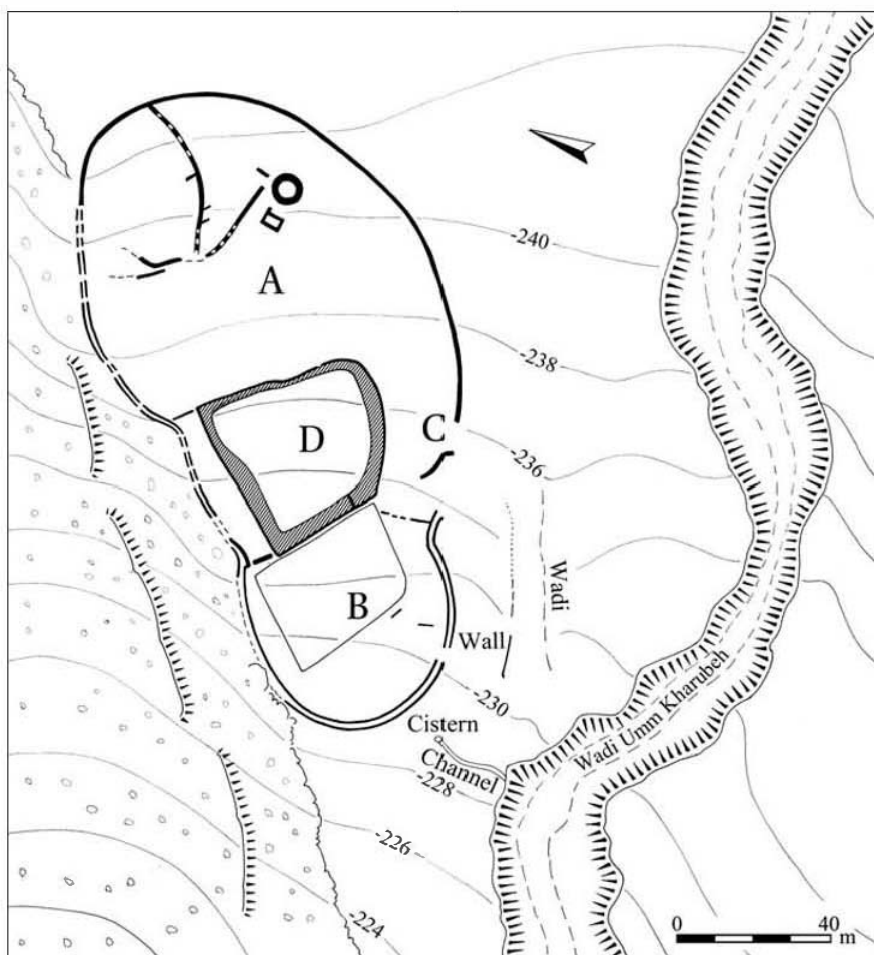
The enclosure contains four main parts: A – the large north-eastern area; B – the smaller south-western area; C – the entrance area; and D – the inner courtyard:

The north-eastern part (A) is an irregular oval about 100 m in long and maximum about 90 m wide. On the northern side it touches the rocky slope where the enclosure wall ascends here on the slope, combining with the natural rock. The enclosure wall divides here into three separate differing parts:

- On the slope large boulders placed in contact;

- In the eastern area, close to the road leading to the new water reservoir, and in the south-eastern part, is a wall built of a double row of large stones.
- In the northern section is a 15-m stretch of the enclosure wall, built of especially large boulders, standing to a height of 2–3 m, which seems to have been its original height.

About 11 m from the enclosure wall stands a unique circular stone structure 6.2 m in diameter. This structure seems to have been built together with the whole site because a wall connected it to the construction leads toward the enclosure wall at the same level, and was probably connected to it. It is built of relatively



129. Plan of Bedhat esh-Sha'ab. Note the unique location between Wadi Umm Kharubeh riverbed and the cliffslope at north-west.

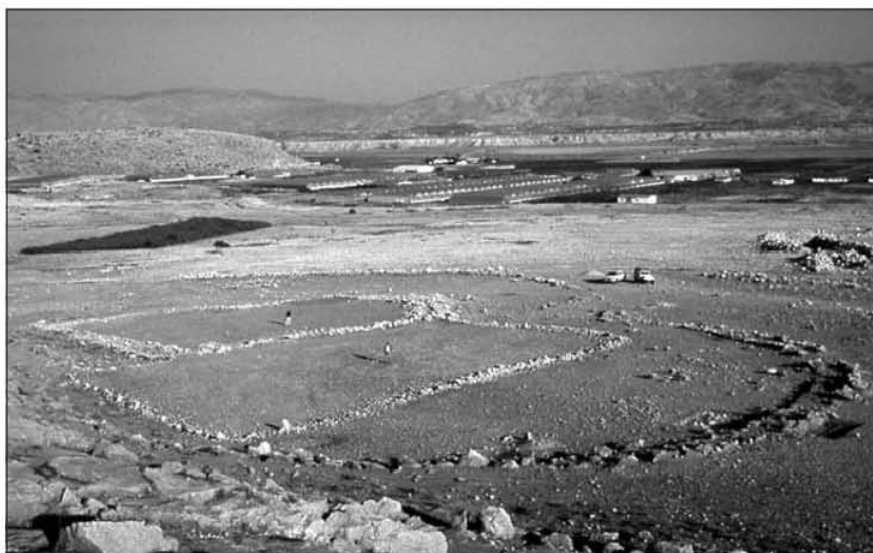


130. The enclosure in Bedhat esh-Sha'ab, aerial view to the west, 1997 (M. Weinberg).

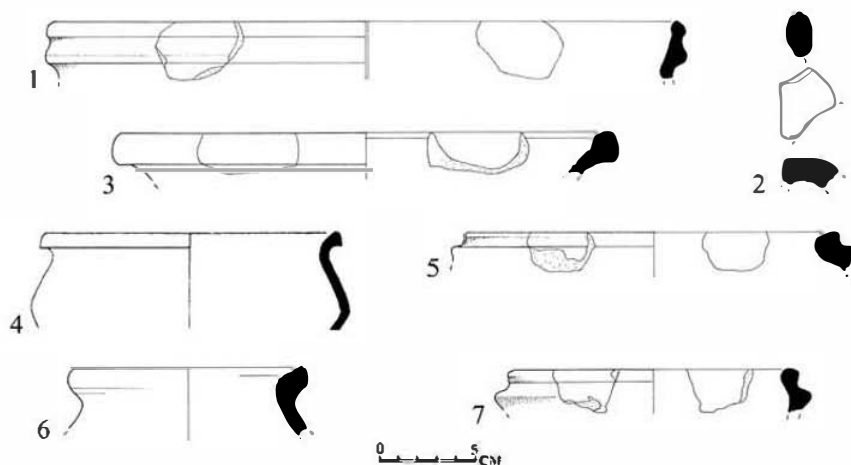


131. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab, Area B (the 'sandal heel') and the 'processional way', view to the south, 2002 (R. Be'eri).

large fieldstones: the outer row of stones is laid in the header method, that is, the narrow side of the stones is directed outwards. The stones inside the outer row are jumbled, the result of the collapse of the construction. Judging by the quantity of stones around it before excavation, it seems that two more courses stood upon the present building: the height of it was, according to this, about 1.5–2 m above the surface of the site.



132. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab enclosure, looking south-east. In the background is the Jordan Valley with the Gilead Mountains behind, 2003 (R. Be'eri).



133. Pottery from the survey at Bedhat esh-Sha'ab: 1, 4. CPs, dk brn, Ir I; 2. Jug handle, brn, LR; 3. Bowl, brn, LR; 5, 7. CPs, dk brn, Ir II; 6. Jar, buff, Ir I-II.

To the north-east of the circular structure is another sub-division, marked by an inner wall built of two rows of large stones. It forms sort of inner 'quarter' with the outer enclosure wall, and here were found various meagre construction remains and a few walls.

The south-western part (B) is the 'heel' of the 'sandal', measuring about 50×50 m, and where it joins (A) is the built entrance to the enclosure (C). The enclosure wall here, like the south-eastern side of Area A, is built of two rows of large local fieldstones, 80×60 cm on average; but here a special paved road is created. This 'processional way' is slightly curved, and about 85 m long. The 'way' is built of two rows of stones 2–2.5 m apart, an inner row and an outer one. While the stones of the inner row lie mostly parallel to the surface in a bench-like manner, most of the outer ones are standing. Between the two rows is what seems to be the remains of a rough pavement, raised about 20–30 cm above the surface. Thus, a special 'way' or passage was created, paved, and slightly raised. The function of this 'way' is hard to determine because of the lack of any parallels known to us. Nevertheless, some points can be suggested. (1) The 'way' cannot have been used for protection or defense, as it is an open construction with relatively large spaces between the stones. (2) As a part of the enclosure wall, it must have been used together with the latter. (3) The special construction cannot have been accidental, it cannot have been used for animals, and the best function we can suggest is a ceremonial or cultic one.

Another construction is a rectangular enclosure, encircled with a thin wall built of small stones, all built in recent years, and not part of the ancient site.

The entrance to the site (C) is located in the east in the contact point of the 'sole' and 'heel' of the 'sandal'. Here was found a built, possibly paved, entrance, 3 m wide, including a wall that protrudes into the enclosure area. It seems that the entrance was along this wall.

The inner courtyard (D) is in the narrowest part of the enclosure, close to the 'heel' and west of the entrance (C). This is a large irregular courtyard, measuring about 40×40 m, encircled by a wall, two stone rows (1 m) wide. The courtyard is elevated 1–2 m above the enclosure surface by a ramp, which rests on the rocky slope. Around the courtyard wall are stones from a collapse, and it was probably higher in ancient times. There are many indications that the courtyard was built as an integral part of the entire enclosure and is contemporary with it.

This impressive site belongs to the Biblical *Gilgal* type (together with el-Unuq, site 160 in Zertal 2008, and Sites 92 and 105 in this volume). It seems to have been built during the IA I, and its use continued during IA II and possibly later. Judging by the remains of structures, the wall shape and breadth, and the entrance, it served as a place of gathering or worship, at least some time during its existence.

For more details see Appendix B.

Pottery: Iron I – 60%; Iron II – 20%; Late Roman-Byzantine – 15%; Early Moslem – 5%.

Flint: see Appendix B.

Stone: see Appendix B.

Additional surveys: none.

Additional Bibliography: Zertal 1998b: 246-247; 2000: 249-258; Zertal and Ben-Yosef 2009.



Site 66: 19-17/83/1

SIRET EL-MA'AZEB (2)

Israel grid: 1987/1737

UTM grid: 7371/5608

Elevation: 260 m b.s.l., 10 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: courtyard and caves

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
3.5 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
400 m distant

Visit: Nov. 1989; 57 sherds

This is a cave site in the Jordan Valley fringes, situated about 1.5 km south of Argaman.

The site is next to a large cliff rising from the valley level; one of the cliffs enclosing the agricultural area of Argaman in the west, and forming the eastern part of the Umm Kharubeh ridge. The cliff is about 15 m high and in it are the openings of two caves close to each other. The cave openings are separated by a large rock about 3 m wide.

In front of the caves is a large courtyard, measuring about 30×15 m. The courtyard joins the cave openings, and its wall creates a ramp 1 m high above the valley plain.

Another irregular slightly elevated courtyard is found by the cliff 80 m to the west of the centre of the site.

Between and inside the courtyards and on the slope are scattered many sherds from various periods, attesting to a long presence.

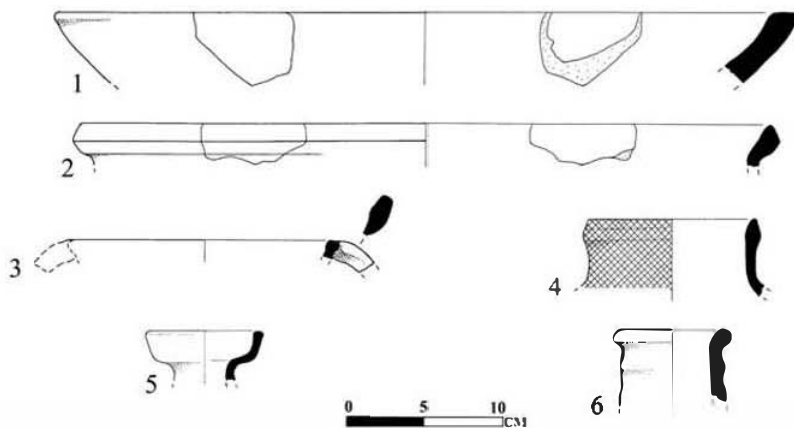
Pottery: Iron II – 15%; Hellenistic – 10%; Early Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 35%; Early Moslem – 15%; Middle Ages – 5%.

Flint: 2 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



134. Aerial view of Siret el-Ma'azeb (2), 2013 (A. Solomon).



135. Pottery from Siret el-Ma'azeb (2): 1. Large bowl, buff, Ir II; 2. Bowl, gr, MA; 3. Jug/flask, buff, Ir II; 4. Jar, gr slip, EM; 5. Juglet, brn, ER; 6. Jar, brn, ER.

Site 67: 19-17/83/2

SIRET EL-MA'AZEB (1)

Israel grid: 1984/1733

UTM grid: 7369/56●3

Elevation: 25● m b.s.l., 4● m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 1 dunam (1●●● sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Judea Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

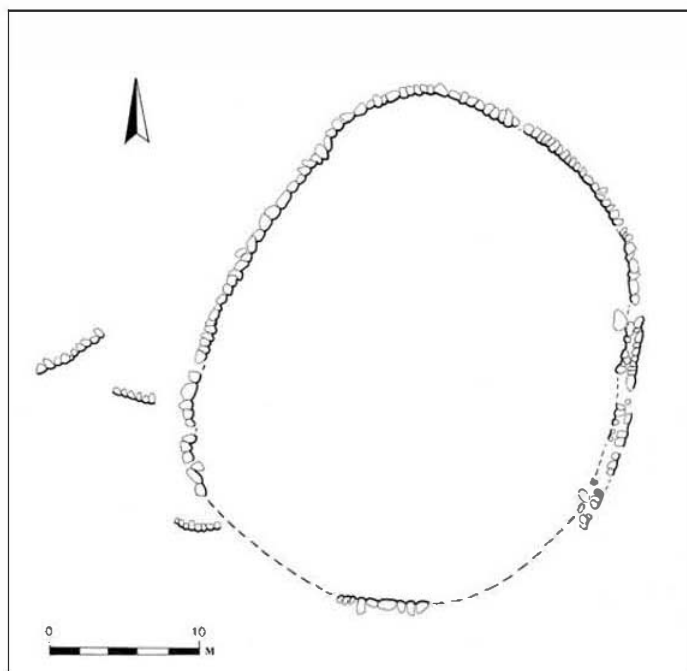
Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (1●4),
2.5 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B1●),
3●● m distant

Visit: Nov. 1989; 4● sherds

This is an enclosure in a small gully which descends eastward into the fringes of the Jordan Valley Valley about 2.5 km south-south-west of Argaman.

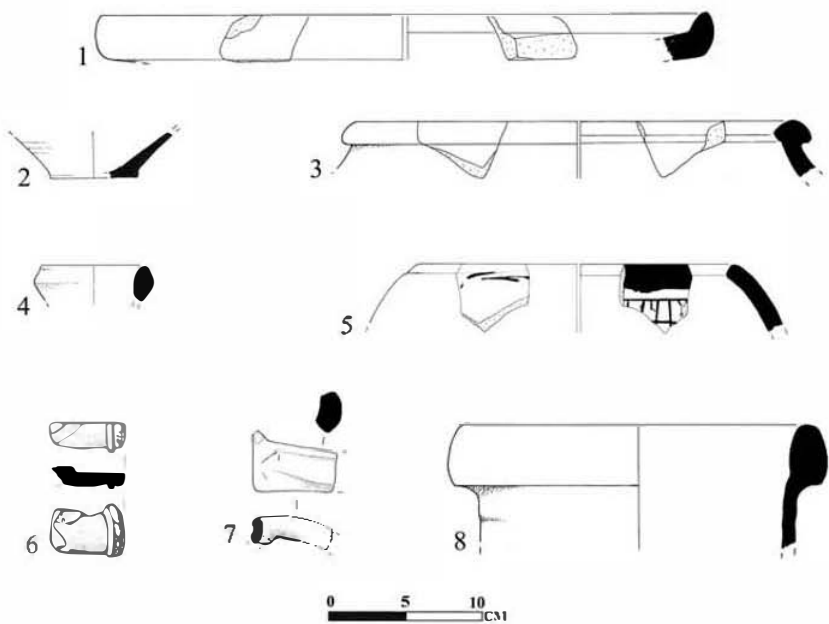
The oval enclosure measures 4●×3● m, and is encircled by a wall built of a single row of medium-sized stones, measuring 4●–5● cm. There is a small pottery scatter, mainly body fragments.



136. Plan of Siret el-Ma'azeb (1).



137. Aerial view of Siret el-Ma'azeb (1), looking west, 2013 (A. Solomon).



138. Pottery from Siret el-Ma'azeb (1): 1. Bowl, lt gr, MA; 2. Bowl base, buff, Byz; 3. Krater, dk brn, Ir II; 4. Jug, dk brn, Ir II; 5. HM, buff, violet dec over cream, MA (Mam); 6. Pipe, Ott; 7. Jug handle, Byz; 8. Jar, gr, MA.

The site belongs to the circular enclosure type, characteristic of the western fringes of the Jordan Valley, and it is likely that it served mainly for animal husbandry.

Pottery: Iron II – 45%; Byzantine – 40%; Middle Ages – 10%; Ottoman – 5%.

Flint: 2 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 68:19-17/72/1

TELLUL EL-BEDHA (2)

Israel grid: 1975/1728

UTM grid: 7359/5597

Elevation: 70 m b.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: encampment

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: saddle

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

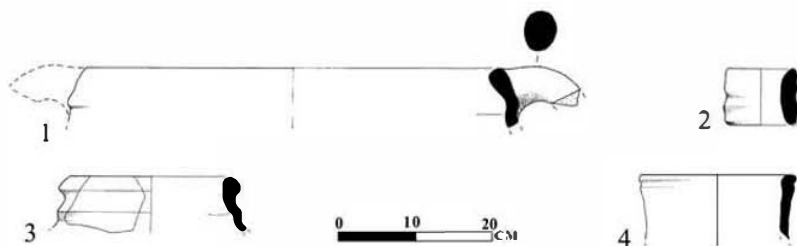
Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104), 1.6 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10), 1 km distant

Visit: Jan. 1994; 36 sherds

This is a sherd scatter in the saddle in the southern part of Ras el-Kharubeh. From this saddle steep wadis descend to the east and west.

On the saddle are remains of stone circles, which apparently served as tent bases. The entire area of the tent encampment is cleared of stones, with stone circles – evidence of *tabuns* (ovens).



139. Pottery from Tellul el-Bedha (2): 1. Cooking krater, dk brn, Ir I; 2. Jug handle, Ir II; 3. Jar, dk brn, Ir II; 4. Jar, lt brn, Byz.

The site is crossed by a modern vehicle road from el-Makhruq, descending to the northern Buqe'ah Valley.

Pottery: Iron I-II – 15%; Byzantine – 70%; Ottoman – 15%.

Flint: 4 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 69: 19-17/82/1

WADI EL-MUGHAREB

Israel grid: 1981/1729

UTM grid: 7365/5599

Elevation: 190 m b.s.l., 50 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: shoulder on a steep slope

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
2 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
500 m distant

Visit: Dec. 1994; 63 sherds

This is an enclosure on a high shoulder overlooking the Jordan Valley north of the Jiftlik, about 2.5 km south-south-west of Argaman. North of the enclosure is a ravine and rock surfaces attached to it. The site enjoys good views to the east and south-east.

The site is situated in a round hollow, surrounded by steep rocky slopes in the west, north and south. The built enclosure is slightly elliptical, and measures 40×36 m. It is encircled by a stone wall about 1.5 m wide, built of two or three rows of medium-sized stones, and in the east it joins a low rocky cliff. In the south a small room adjoins the enclosure, and inside it to the south-east is a 20 m-long structure divided into two rooms, built parallel to the wall.

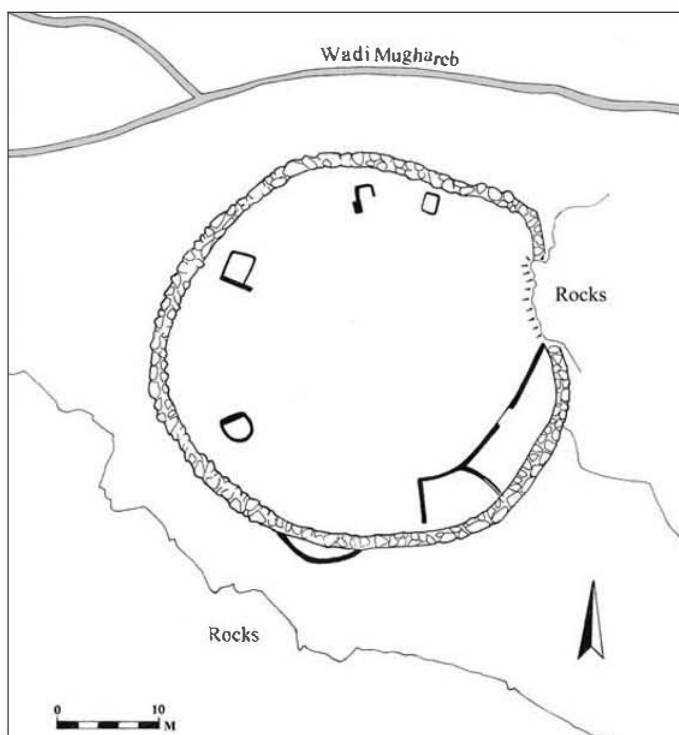
Inside the enclosure are four small structures that appear to have been stone-built tombs, and next to them is a round structure 2–3 m in diameter. These tombs are probably later than the habitation period of the enclosure, and the structure next to them served for offerings.

Small sherds were collected, mostly body fragments. Noteworthy is a 'Manasseh' IA I bowl rim.

The site, belonging to the grazing enclosures, is unique in its outstanding location and its significant elevation above the Jordan Valley.

Pottery: Iron I – 42%; Iron II – 40%; Late Roman – 16%; Middle Ages – 2%.

Additional surveys: none.



140. Plan of Wadi el-Mughareb, 1996.



141. The site of Wadi el-Mughareb, looking east, 1996 (S. Hashman).

Site 70: 19-17/82/3

CAVE SITE (1)

Israel grid: 1982/1728

UTM grid: 7367/5598

Elevation: 240 m b.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name: given by the Survey team

Site type: cave and courtyard

Area: 4 dunams (4000 sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104), 2 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10), 200 m distant

Visit: Nov. 1989; 29 sherds

Dwelling caves in a cliff above Wadi Gharbi, in the Jordan Valley margins, about 3.2 km south-south-west of Argaman.

There are six shallow cave openings or rock shelters. In the gully below the caves is a thick support wall or terrace, creating a platform in front of the caves. In the slope below the caves are wall remains, either slope-strengthening or structure remains, and a single complete rectangular structure.

Pottery: Byzantine – 100%.**Stone:** a basalt oval mano (see Eitam 2005: 692).**Additional surveys:** none.

Site 71: 19-17/82/2

TELLUL EL-BEDHA (1)

Israel grid: 1981/1721

UTM grid: 7366/5591

Elevation: 250 m b.s.l., 40 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: medium-sized and enclosure

Area: 6 dunams (6000 sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

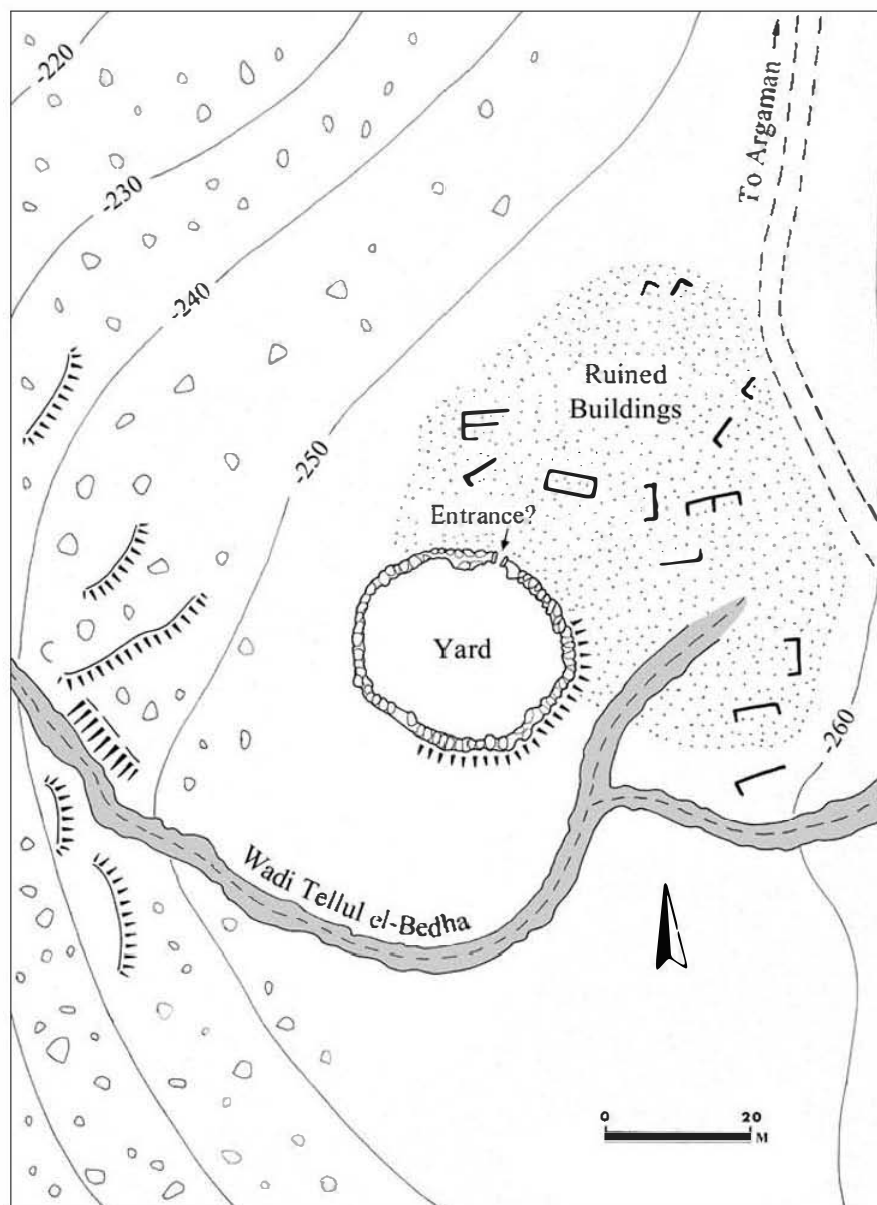
Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104), 1.2 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10), next to the site

Visit: Dec. 1989; 191 sherds

This is a medium-sized site in a small 'bay', which penetrates from the Jordan Valley to the Ras Khar beh ridge, about 3.5 km south of Argaman, and 1.5 km north of the Jiftlik junction.

The site location is in the gully of Tell el-Bedha, next to a small ravine and the cliff slopes to its north. In the upper western part of site is a circular

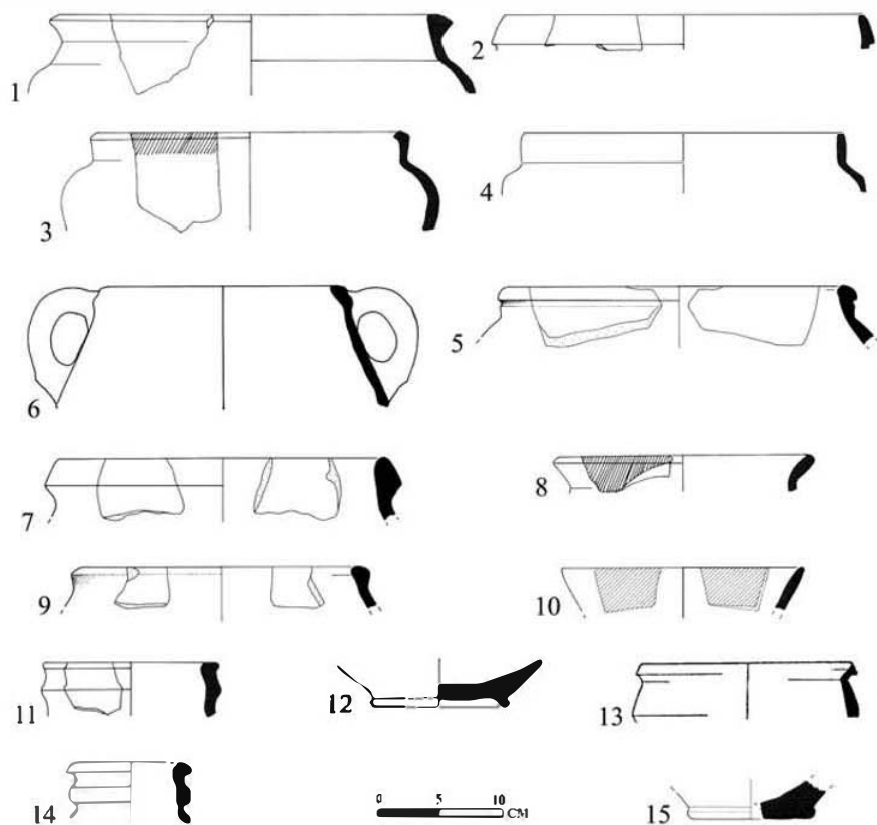


142. Plan of Tellul el-Bedha (1), 2001.

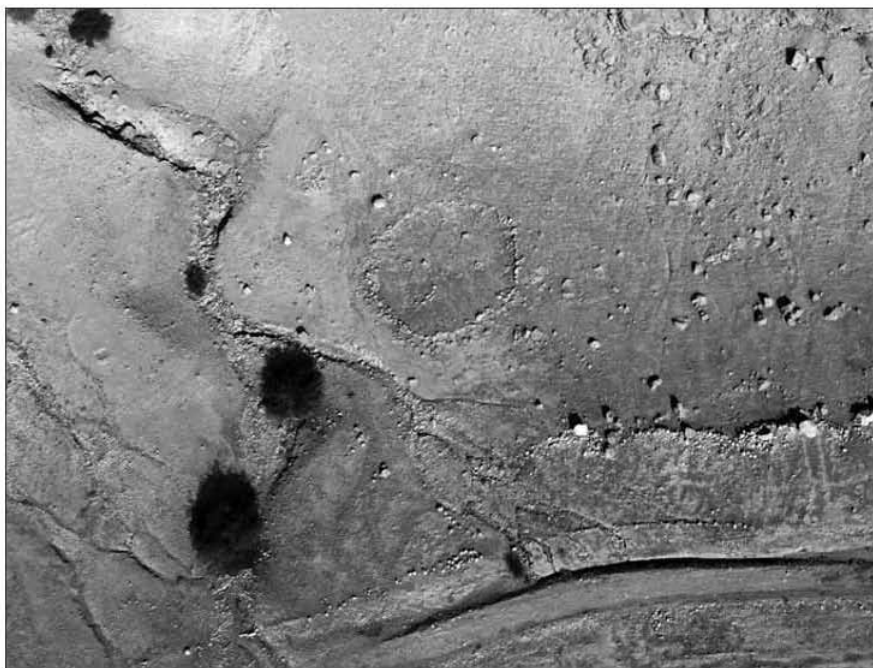
enclosure, about 25 m in diameter. The wall encircling it is built of large field-stones laid in one row. East of the enclosure and slightly below it, are fieldstone structure remains; among them square and round structures, used for dwelling. Most of the structures were damaged by a bulldozer while paving the nearby dirt track leading from Argaman to the Jiftlik junction. Over the whole area were revealed foundations of many walls and much pottery.

The unpaved road passes through the centre of the site; and east of it, in the floodplain, are scattered building stones and sherds. In the upper part of the gully there are agricultural steps and cave openings.

In the site were found many red slip and burnished 'Phoenician' sherds, dated to the 11th to 9th centuries BCE that were not found in other sites along the Jordan Valley.



143. Pottery from Tellul el-Bedha (1): 1. Bowl, lt brn, Ir II; 2, 13. CPs, dk brn, Ir I; 3. Bowl, brn, rd band on the rim, Ir II; 4, 9. Kraters, lt brn, Ir I; 5. Krater, lt brn, Ir II; 6. CP, brn, Ir II; 7. Krater, lt brn, Ir I-II; 8, 10. Bowls, buff, rd slip, Ir II; 11. Jar, lt brn, Ir II; 12, 15. Bowl bases, buff, Ir II; 14. Jar, lt brn, Ir II.



144. Aerial view of Tellul el-Bedha (1), 2013 (A. Solomon).

Pottery: Intermediate Bronze – 5%; Iron I – 43%; Iron II – 45%; Unidentified – 7%.

Flint: 155 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 72:19-17/81/1

EL-MAKHRUQ (1)

Israel grid: 1984/1715

UTM grid: 7369/5585

Elevation: 25● m b.s.l., 4● m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: large, structure and caves

Area: 5● dunams (5 ha)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 6

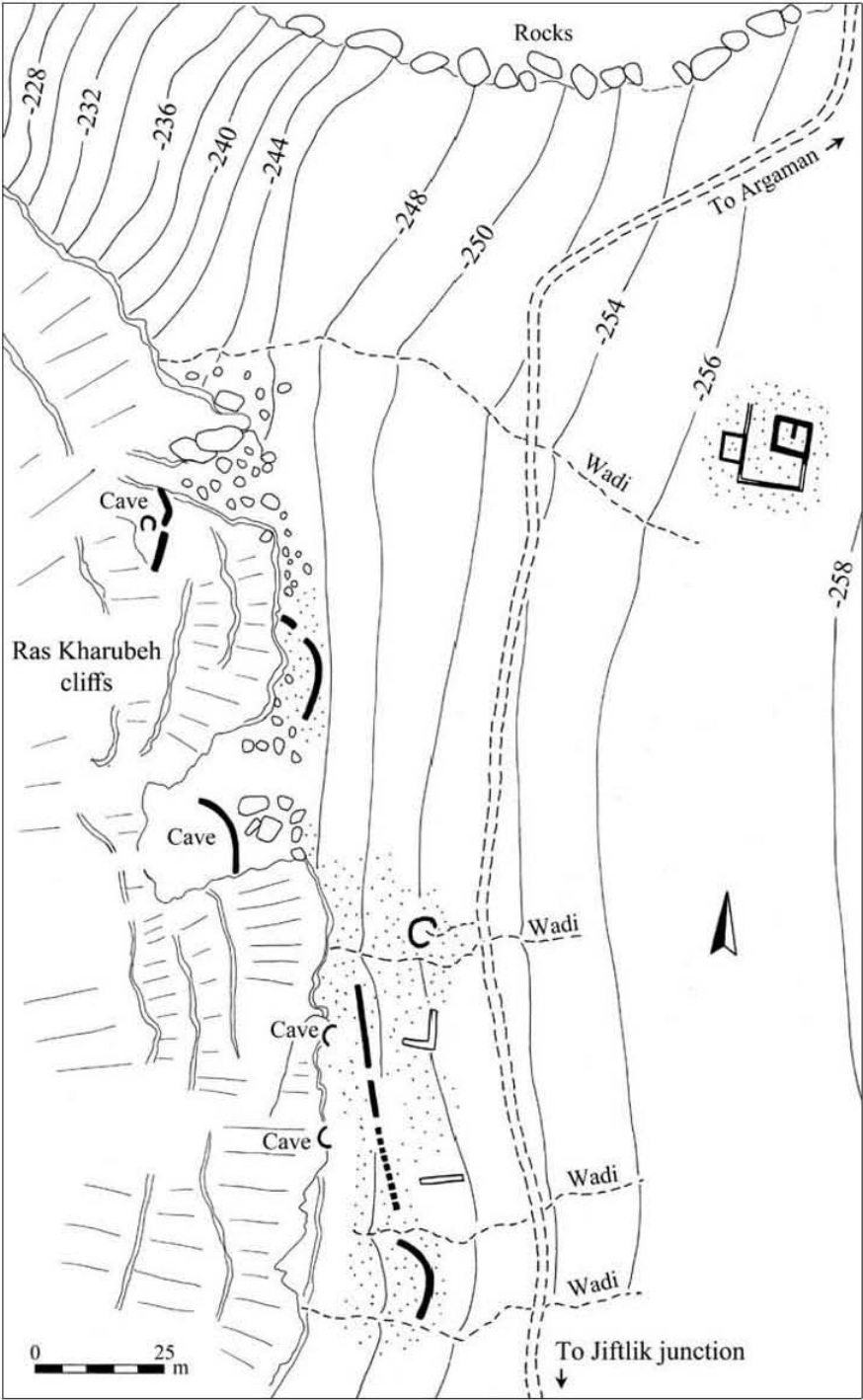
Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (1●4),
1.2 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B1●),
next to the site

Visit: Dec. 1989, plan - winter 2●●2; 112
sherds



145. Plan of el-Makhrūq (1), 2001.

A large site in a narrow valley in the western fringes of the Jordan Valley, about 1.2 km north of the junction of the road from Wadi Far'ah to Damia Bridge (B₃) with the Beit She'an–Jericho road (B1●).

Most of the site is adjacent to the eastern escarpment of the Kharubeh ridge, dropping to the Jordan Valley by a series of rocky slopes with caves. The remains are divided into three parts, from north to south:

1. In the area where there is a rocky extension eastward from Kharubeh ridge are a few construction remains with EB II sherds (not on the plan). In this place stood a single structure, probably related to the large EB site in el-Makhruq (Zertal 2008: site 269).
2. About 75 m south of the former, along the ridge, are a structure and a courtyard. The structure is built of large stones, measuring 6×6 m, and is divided into two rooms, western and eastern, and a large courtyard. In one of the walls is an opening with a cut threshold stone with bolt holes. The dating of the structure is not certain. South and west of the structure is attached a built courtyard, only partially preserved. It is built of small stones and measures 15×10 m.
3. Along the edge of the western cliff are four or five courtyards, attached to the cliff or to the caves in it; all built as a semicircle or rectangle, of especially large stones (up to 500 kg each). Occasionally, projecting eastward, are more small circular courtyards. In one of them was revealed an opening built of large standing upright stones. In this area are also several



146. Ras Kharubeh cliffs near el-Makhruq (1), 1999.

caves in the cliffs, with courtyards, most built in the Iron Ages, in front of them. Around the courtyards are scattered sherds of various periods.

The site at el-Makhrûq is possibly linked to the fortified EB city mentioned above. It is very probable that it is also connected to the IACitadel in el-Makhrûq, positioned on a large tell on the south-eastern side of Kharubeh ridge (Site 73).

It seems that these courtyards and pens are part of the agricultural areas of the hinterland of the fortified sites at el-Makhrûq. These agricultural structures continued in use through the Byz and MA Periods.

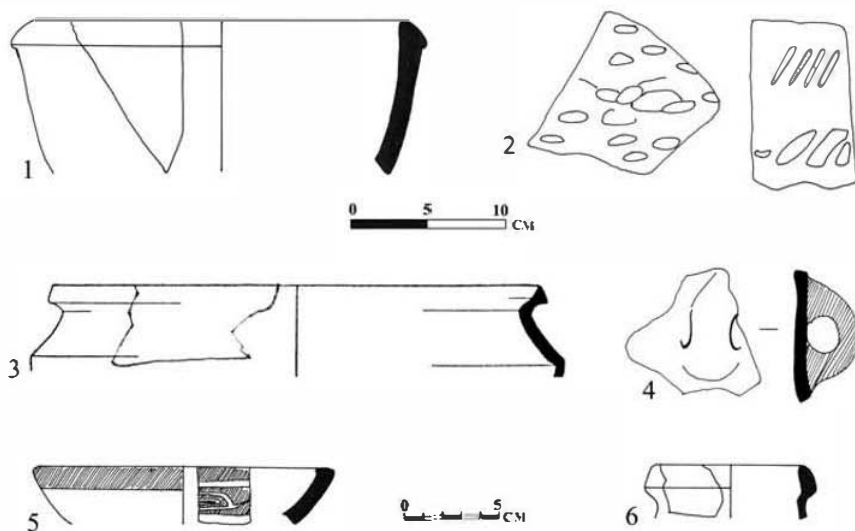
Pottery: Early Bronze I-II – 10%; Iron I – 30%; Iron II – 20%; Byzantine – 30%; Middle Ages – 10%.

Flint: 1 Neolithic axe, see Appendix A.

Stone: a basalt grinding stone (see Eitam 2005: 692).

Additional surveys: none.

Additional Bibliography: Bar 2014a, site 63.



147. Pottery from el-Makhrûq (1): 1. Bowl, gr, MA?; 2. Plastic dec on sherd, EB; 3. CP, dk brn, Ir I; 4. Lug handle, rd slip, EB; 5. Bowl, buff, yel glazing, MA; 6. Jug, brn, Byz.

Site 73: 19-17/80/1
EL-MAKHUQ (2)

Israel grid: 1984/1709	Soil quality: 2
UTM grid: 7369/5579	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 240 m b.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: nearest place	Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104), 700 m distant
Site type: fort	Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10), next to the site
Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)	Visits: Nov. 1993, March 2001 and later; 150 sherds
Topography: prominent hilltop	
Rock type: Avdat Group	
Soil type: stony-desert	

A fort on a prominent hilltop in the eastern margins of the el-Makhrûq ridge, one of the Makhrûq site complex, about 4.5 km south-south-west of Argaman. From the hilltop there is a good view to the Wadi Far'ah floodplain and the Jordan Valley.

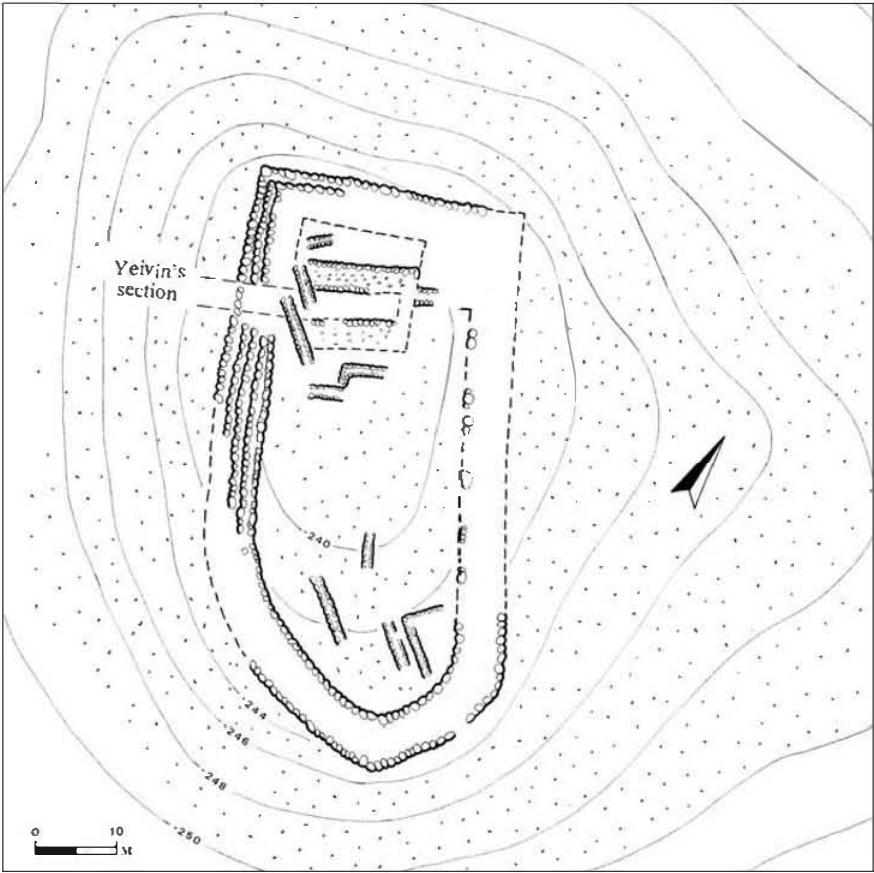
The fort lies on the oval hilltop controlling the roads (B3 and B10) and Wadi Far'ah. It is a rectangle 70×40 m, with the northern side curved. The fort is based on a podium consisting of a 5–6 m-wide wall with five rows of large fieldstones encircling the entire slope. On the platform at the top of the fort are the remains of many structures, with walls of different widths. Due to the extensive destruction it is very difficult to define the plans of the structures.

The western slope of the fort is cut, exposing the podium and other walls. It seems that this section was excavated by Yeivin in 1974, but it has not been reported.

On the slopes and the summit are considerable numbers of sherds from all the occupations, mainly from the EB and IA II. It is obvious that the fort was built on top of an earlier structure, and it seems that the EB city also occupied this hilltop.

On April 1870 Guérin (1969: 235–238) visited while travelling through the Jordan Valley. It is likely that he called the fort Tell Makhrûq, although some of the details given by him are illogical. This is his description (Guérin 1969: 235): "Several minutes' distance further to the east rises Tell Makhrûq commanding the plain from about 30 m above. Its summit measures 58 m by 29 m near the middle, and at its ends it is much narrower. I observed on it lines of walls marking several small cells."

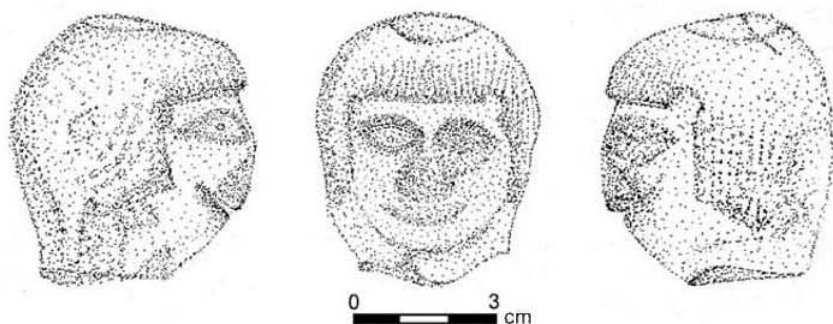
The British Survey members visited the place, repeated Guérin's observations, and added a few details concerning the quarried caves in the slope of Ras Kharubeh (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 402).



148. Plan of el-Makhrūq (2), 2001.



149. El-Makhrūq (2) (marked with an arrow), view to the south, 2003 (M. Einav).



150. Ammonite style figurine head found in el-Makhrûq (2).

In the Emergency Survey (Bar-Adon 1972, site 4) the site description is unclear. It seems that it should read: "A tell measuring 70×40 m, at coordinates 1984/1710. At its top are structures and remains of a wall 2 m wide and 3 m high; preserved up to five courses of large stones."

Pottery: Early Bronze I-II – 23%; Middle Bronze II – 5%; Iron II – 71%, unidentified – 1%.

Flint: 12 items, EB, see Appendix A.

Special find: Ammonite style figurine head (Fig. 150).

Identification: possible identification with Tzartan (Josh 3:16; 1 Kgs 7:46), see Chapter 2.

Additional surveys: Bar-Adon 1972: site 4.

Additional Bibliography: Damati et al. 1993 (with additional bibliography); Hizmi 2004; *NEAEHL* 5: 2101 (for additional Bibliography); Zertal 2008, site 269.



Site 74: 19-17/81/2

EL-MAKHRUQ (3)

Israel grid: 1987/1710

UTM grid: 7373/5580

Elevation: 280 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: medium size

Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)

Topography: marshy plain

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: sandy silt

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
1 km distant

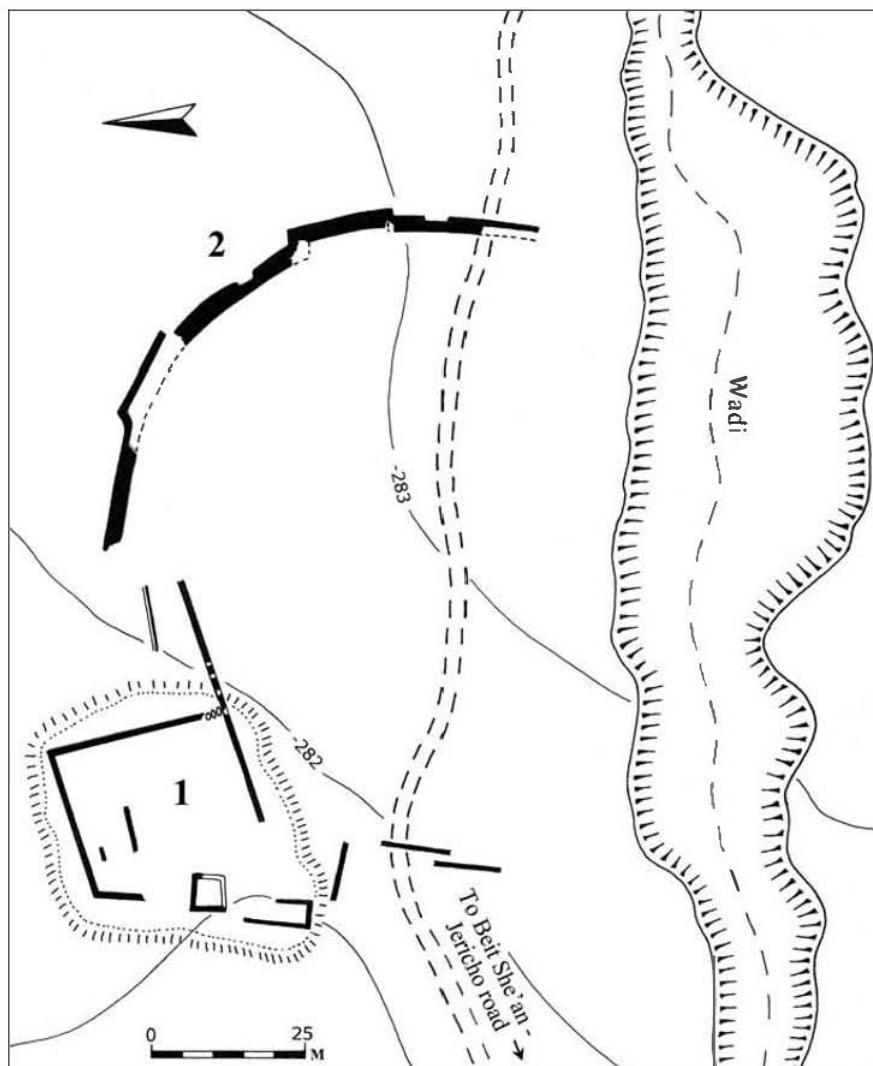
Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
300 m distant

Visit: March 2002; 68 sherds

This is a large site in the marshy plain east of el-Makhruq (2) and east of the Jordan Valley road. South of the site are water channels and a deep wadi, and nearby to the east are palm groves.

There are two main parts to the site:

1. An enclosure encircled by a wall of large stones, most of which have been robbed, over a low hillock on which a large electricity pylon now stands. The enclosure measures about 25×25 m. In its south-western part are remains of various structures of cut stones, mostly robbed. From the enclosure are walls leading south in the direction of the wadi, and others



151. Plan of el-Makhruq (3), 2002.

eastward to the plain. The function of the walls is unclear. All these walls, which are 60 cm wide, are built with a bed of small stones supporting a row or two of large stones.

2. About 80 m east of the enclosure is a particularly thick wall, encircling the site in a semicircle, from north and east in the plain. The wall is 2–4 m wide, and is built of large stones in an offset-inset manner. The wall turns south towards the wadi for a short distance, and is probably dismantled further on. The relation between the wall and the enclosure is uncertain.

In the site were found remains of a Roman farm or villa, east of which was a thick wall, which looks like a fortification. The nature of the entire complex is still unclear, needing additional research and comparisons.

It is probable that Guérin (1969: 236–237) saw the complex and referred to it.

Next to the Jordan Valley road, near the site, were found remains of several Medieval or Ottoman structures.

Some of the pottery collected contains sherds which were probably washed down from el-Makhrûq (2).

Pottery: Early Bronze I–II – 15%; Iron II – 7% (the sherds from the above periods possibly originating from el-Makhrûq [2]); Late Roman-Byzantine – 62%; Middle Ages – 16% (from the structures by the road).

Additional surveys: none.



152. The site at el-Makhrûq (3), view to the west. The jeep is in the centre of the site and in the background is Umm Kharubeh ridge, 2002 (M. Einav).

CHAPTER FIVE

NAHAL TIRZAH FLOODPLAIN

LANDSCAPE UNIT 29



153. A Moslem Wedding Ceremony, engraving (Geikie 1887).

Site 75: 19-17/45/1

KHIRBET WADI UMM WATAD (1)

Israel grid: 1949/1751	Soil quality: 5
UTM grid: 7333/5621	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 160 m b.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: Ancient and on map	Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
Site type: medium size and fortified	400 m distant
Area: 12.5 dunams (1.25 ha)	Road: Shechem-Jiftlik (B3),
Topography: spur at ridge margin	200 m distant
Rock type: Avdat Group	Visits: March 1983, March 2001;
Soil type: stony-desert	66 sherds

A site in the northern part of the Wadi Far'ah floodplain, in the margins of the Kharubeh ridge, 4.5 km west of Argaman and close to the road descending from Shechem to the Damia Bridge.

The site is divided into two parts: the upper part is on a narrow rocky spur descending from the Umm Kharubeh ridge south to Wadi Far'ah. This part is above and east of Wadi Umm Watad, which empties into Wadi Far'ah. The second, lower, part of the site is in a small valley between the ridge and the road.

In the upper part, on the spur, were found remains of structures built of medium-sized fieldstones, some square and some rounded. There are passages between the structures. It is probable that the site was fortified by a wall, remains of which are visible in the upper part.

In the lower part, in the valley, are remains of a few walls and scattered sherds. Nowadays the place is filled with houses of the tenants who cultivate the Jiftlik fields.

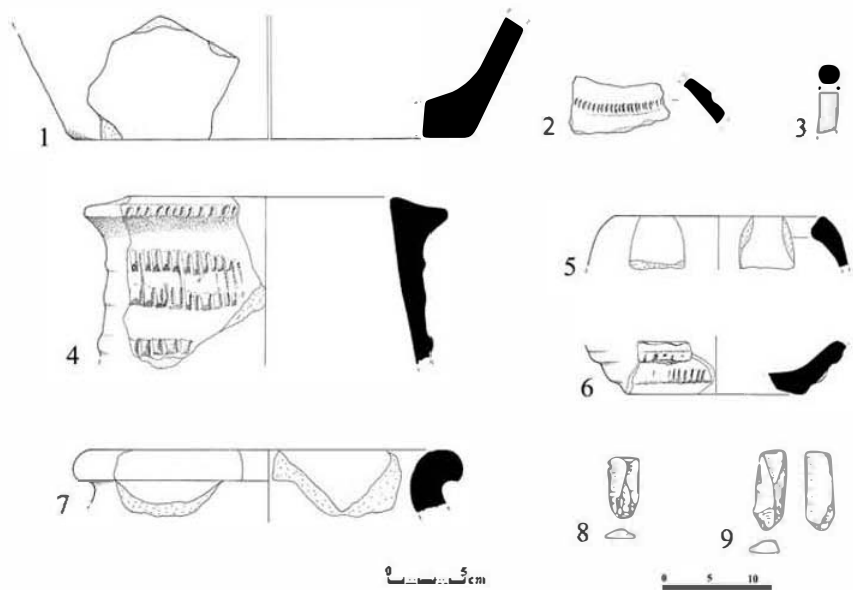
The place was found by Porath (1968: site 117), who described it as: "A very large ruin above Wadi el-Far'ah and to the east of Wadi Umm Watad. Its area is about 30 dunams. The ruin is partially covered by silt from the mountains and scattered on it are modern dwellings built of mudbrick. In the sections and pits for the digging of clay for the mudbricks can be seen many foundations of structures built of fieldstones of varying sizes, various debris and many sherds. It seems that the maximum size of the ruin was in the Early Canaanite II Period. Later, in the Israelite I-II Period, only the south-western part was inhabited."

In our opinion, Porat's description relates partially to Site 78.

In a repeat visit (2001) much EB I pottery was found, but the structures



154. Khirbet Wadi Umm Watad (1), view to the west, 1983. The site location is behind and above the village houses, over the spur descending to Wadi Far'ah (A. Zertal).



155. Finds from Khirbet Wadi Umm Watad (1), all EB I (except no. 7): 1. Base, buff; 2. Incision dec on sherd, buff; 3. Juglet handle, buff; 4. Jar, Um Hammad Ware rope dec, buff; 5. HM, gr; 6. Base, Um Hammad Ware rope dec, buff; 7. Jar, buff, EB II; 8-9. Flint blades.

observed in the previous visit were not found. The most significant items in the pottery assemblage from the site are of the Um Hammad Ware pottery style characteristic of the EB Ib of the Jordan Valley (see Bar 2010).

Pottery: Early Bronze I – 80%; Early Bronze II – 20%.

Flint: 2 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: Porath 1968: site 117.

Additional Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 51.



Site 76: 19-17/55/1

KHIRBET WADI UMM WATAD (2)

Israel grid: 1954/1754

UTM grid: 7338/5623

Elevation: 50 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: about 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),

800 m distant

Road: Shechem–Jiftlik (B3),

500 m distant

Visit: March 2001; 20 sherds

A site built on the moderate southern slope of Jebel el-Muṣafah close to one of Wadi Umm Watad's upper branches. The slope descends from the Ras Kharubeh cliffs south to the Wadi Far'ah floodplain.

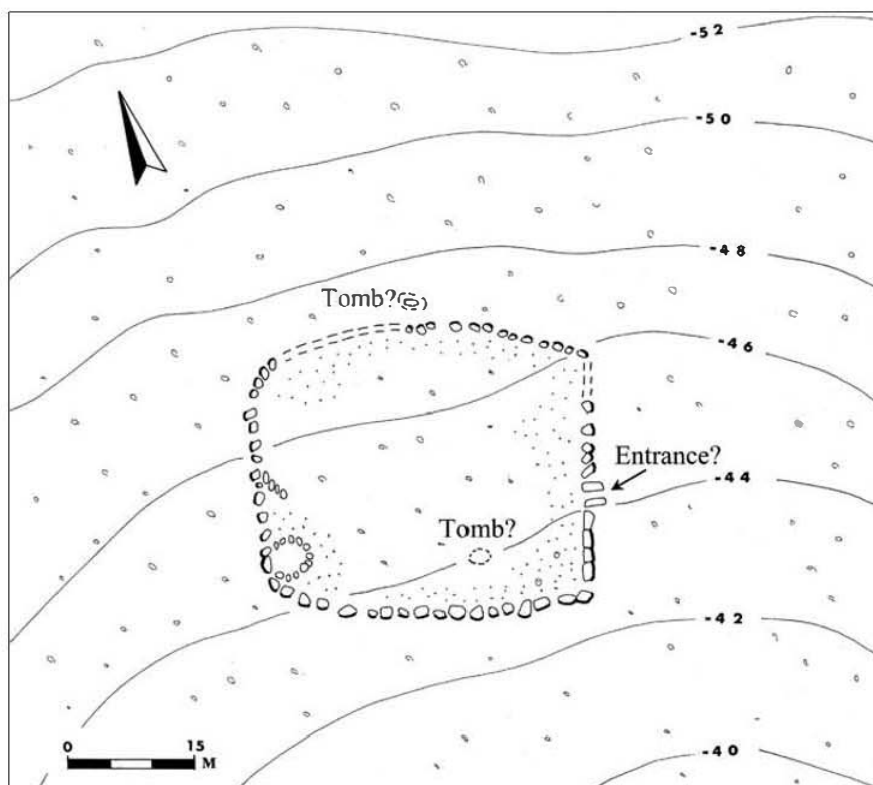
The enclosure measures about 40×32 m, and is built of one row of large stones. In the eastern wall the entrance was built of two standing monoliths (now fallen), 1 m apart.

The north wall is not well preserved, having being built of smaller stones. There were probably additional walls inside the enclosure. In the south-western corner is a round structure about 3 m in diameter, with a robbing pit inside it. In and around the enclosure were found two more small structures, perhaps tombs. There is a meagre sherd scatter.

Pottery: Iron I – 60%; Byzantine – 40%.

Flint: 8 items, probably IA, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



156. Plan of Khirbet Wadi Umm Watad (2), 2001.



Site 77:19-17/44/1

SHUNET EL-MASNA'AH

Israel grid: 1944/1745

UTM grid: 7328/5614

Elevation: 19● m b.s.l., 7● m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: large

Area: 1●● dunams (1● ha)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: silt and Avdat Group

Soil types: alluvium and forest soils

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (1●4),
2●● m distant

Road: Shechem–Jiftlik (B3),
6●● m distant

Visit: April 1995; 45 sherds

This is a large site in the western margins of the Wadi Far'ah floodplain, south of the narrowest part of the wadi (Bab ed-Dayyq). It is located between the confluence of Wadi Zeith with Wadi Far'ah in the south, and the road crossing Wadi Far'ah in the north.

The site stretches at least 400 m along a narrow silt step. This step, whose original height was 2 m above the river floodplain surface, is the result of the silted erosion of the small streams descending eastward. In various places the step has been cut by tractors, and in these sections floors, walls and pottery were revealed. Since its abandonment, this Chalcolithic and EB I site has been covered by silt, and would probably not have been discovered without the tractor operations. The site stretches westward to the small village of Mantaket Wadi Zeith, where it meets Khallet el-Fuleh.

In the British Survey (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 403) is the note "Foundations of a little tower by a chammel of water; heaps of stones." The meaning is not clear; such a tower was not found by our survey.

This is probably the 'Shunet el-Masna'ah A' mentioned by Porath (1968: site 119), described as "a ruin in the step of Wadi Far'ah. Its area is about 5 dunams. The ruin is covered by silt eroded from the mountains. In the sections cut by ravines and pits could be seen accumulations of debris and a few walls built of fieldstones. There are Chalcolithic and Early Bronze period flint artifacts. Noteworthy are basalt items..."

It is likely that the above site is an extension of the sites at the north of the wadi, and the whole of the Wadi Far'ah floodplain was one large Chalcolithic and EB I site.

Pottery: Chalcolithic – 30%; Early Bronze I – 68%; Intermediate Bronze – 2%.

Additional surveys: Porath 1968: site 119 (?).

Additional Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 55.

Site 78: 19-17/54/1

KAZIYET EL-RATRUT

Israel grid: 1958/1741 (centre)
 UTM grid: 7342/5611
 Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.
 Name: nearest place
 Site type: large
 Area: 500 dunams (50 ha)
 Topography: valley margins
 Rock type: silt
 Soil type: alluvium

Soil quality: 8
 Cultivation: vegetables
 Cisterns: many (modern)
 Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
 at the site
 Road: Shechem–Jiftlik (B3),
 next to the site
 Visit: Jan. 1985; 100 sherds

A very large site in the northern part of the Wadi Far'ah floodplain, west of the Damia Bridge junction, and about 3.8 km south-south-west of Argaman. The site lies along the south-western cliffs of the Umm Kharubeh ridge, and between them and the Shechen–Damia road (B3). The settlement may have extended across the road to the south to Wadi Far'ah. Its total area is unknown, because a new village covers most of the area, which is all under cultivation.

Following is the Emergency Survey description: "The site spreads 1800 m between coordinates 1963/1738 and 1948/1750. Kaziyet el-Ratrut is built over it. The camp's inhabitants have been digging clay for bricks in the area. At coordinates 1965/1732 is a 15 m row of alternate standing and lying stones 60–90 cm, with gaps between them of 1.2–1.8 m." (Bar-Adon 1972: site 1).

Gophna and Porath (1972: site 182) remark in Israel grid 1947/1749 "a small Arab village on top of a *khirbe*. The area of the *khirbe* is about 1 dunam. Pottery: Iron Age II and Byzantine."

In our opinion it was only a part of the large site, stretching over the Wadi Far'ah floodplain as far as the Beit She'an–Jericho road.

No Iron Age sherds were found during our visit, perhaps because it was impossible to survey the village.

Pottery (summary of the different surveys): Chalcolithic; Early Bronze I; Iron I-II; Byzantine.

Additional surveys: Bar-Adon 1972: site 1; Gophna and Porath 1972: site 182.

Additional Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 56.

Site 79: 19-17/72/2

FARAT EJ-JIFTLIK

Israel grid: 1971/1720 (centre)	Soil quality: 8
UTM grid: 7356/5590	Cultivation: partial (vegetables)
Elevation: 240 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: nearest place	Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
Site type: large	400 m distant
Area: 200 dunams (20 ha)	Road: Shechem–Jiftlik (B3),
Topography: valley margins	next to the site
Rock type: silt	Visits: 1989-1990; 100 sherds
Soil type: alluvium	

This is a large site in the north-eastern margins of Wadi Far'ah valley, possibly the eastern extension of Site 78.

Mellaart (1962: site 75, and p. 133), who surveyed the place (Grid ref. 1968-1724), writes: "Extensive flat site situated below the line of cliffs bordering the North side of Wadi Far'a, north of Nablus–Damiyeh road. The site extends about 100 m west of the Jiftlik junction with the Jericho road and continues about 1 km along the road. It is a one-period site, Ghassulian Chalcolithic. Recent road repairs widened the ditch north of the road and cut a clean section in the site. As the ground slopes up steeply northward towards the cliffs the maximum depth of deposit is unknown. Near the road about 1–2 m of deposit is visible. This deposit is always covered by natural gravel washed down during the last 5000 years which would have made the discovery of the site impossible, had it not been for the road repairs when a section was cut. Stone foundations of walls and fine pottery including three cornet vases, a fine storage jar and painted bowls was found. This is one of these typical straggling, undefended chalcolithic sites." Above the site he mentions tombs "in rock – at least 3 visible – one cleaned out...", which he connects to Tell esh-Sheikh Mezar (Mellaart 1962: site 93).

The Emergency Survey (Bar-Adon 1972: site 2) gives a slightly different account and noted additional periods of occupation: "The length of the site is about 1850 m, and its area lies between coordinates 1978/1713 and 1967/1728. Its width is undefined because the Far'at ej-Jiftlik camp is built over it. The camp inhabitants dug in it in order to extract clay for bricks. In the sections in the site are seen ash layers, mudbricks and stone walls and large hearths. Stone walls have been preserved up to a height of 2.5 m... Where the site meets the

mountainside are many cave openings. In the southern end of the site, at coordinates 1978/1713, are rectangular and round enclosures, extending for about 150 m. The enclosures are built of large fieldstones, and have been preserved two-three courses high (1.2-1.5 m)... Pottery is from the Chalcolithic (most of the finds), Early Canaanite and Israelite I periods."

This site is a direct extension of the former one (Kaziyet el-Ratrut), and perhaps they should be treated as one. During our survey no IA pottery was found, possibly due to the modern coverage of the site.

Pottery (summary of the different surveys): Chalcolithic; Early Bronze I-II; Iron I.

Additional surveys: Mellaart 1962: sites 75, 93; Bar-Adon 1972, site 2.

Additional Bibliography: Leonard 1992: 5-8; Bar 2014a: site 62.



Site 80: 19-17/43/2

MANTAKET WADI ZEITH

Israel grid: 1946/1738

UTM grid: 7330/5607

Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 50 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: medium size

Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: silt

Soil type: silt

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
400 m distant

Road: Jiftlik-Ṭana (C38),
next to the site

Visit: April 1995; 79 sherds

This is a village of tenants and Bedouin who originate in the village of Beit Furiq near Shechem. The village is built over a medium-sized settlement from different periods. It is located in the northern part of the Wadi Zeith alluvial fan before it joins the Wadi Far'ah floodplain.

The modern village is built over the walls of a LR-EM settlement, with many walls *in situ*, built of one row of large stones or two rows of medium-sized stones. The larger public buildings can be easily distinguished from the dwellings; the walls of the larger ones are straight, i.e. typical LR and Byz period construction.



157. General view of Mantaket Wadi Zeith and Wadi Far'ah, view to the north, 1995 (S. Hashman).

Large numbers of sherds are scattered in many places in the site, where robbing digs or excavations for building foundations took place. In the southern part of the site, facing the channel of Wadi Zeith, are the walls of the more ancient periods. Those from the Chalcolithic, EB and IB are spread beneath and beside the later site.

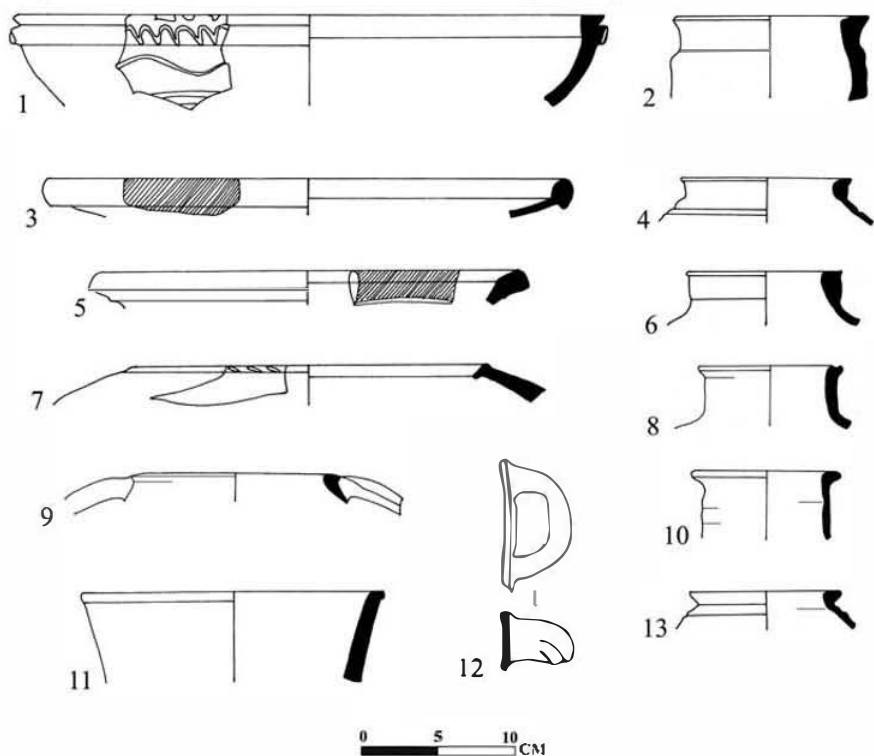
Porath (1968: site 127), who visited the site in 1968, called it Khallet el-Fuleh and described it as: "A small village over a ruin above Wadi Far'ah. Its area is about 5 dunams. The ruin is partially covered by erosion from the mountains. No ancient construction remains are visible on the surface. In pits dug near the houses fieldstone-built walls can be seen. The pottery is from the Byzantine period."

About 500 m to the north-west Porath (1968: site 120) mentions another site, Horvat Shunet el-Masna'a B (Israel grid: 1945/1742), on an area of 3 dunams (3000 sq. m), with Chalcolithic and IB sherds.

Pottery: Chalcolithic – 20%; Early Bronze I – 15%; Intermediate Bronze – 15%; Late Roman – 6%; Byzantine – 30%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 4%.

Additional surveys: Porat 1968: site 127.

Additional Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 57.



158. Pottery from Mantaket Wadi Zeith: 1. Bowl, gr, EM; 2. Jar, buff, MA; 3, 5. Bowls, green glazing, MA; 4, 6. Jars, lt brn, LR; 7. HM, gr, LB; 8, 10. Jars, LR-Byz; 9. CP, brn, Byz; 11. Bowl, brn, Rom; 12. Pan-handle, brn, Byz; 13. Juglet, lt brn, LR.



Site 81: 19-17/43/1

KHALLET EL-FULEH

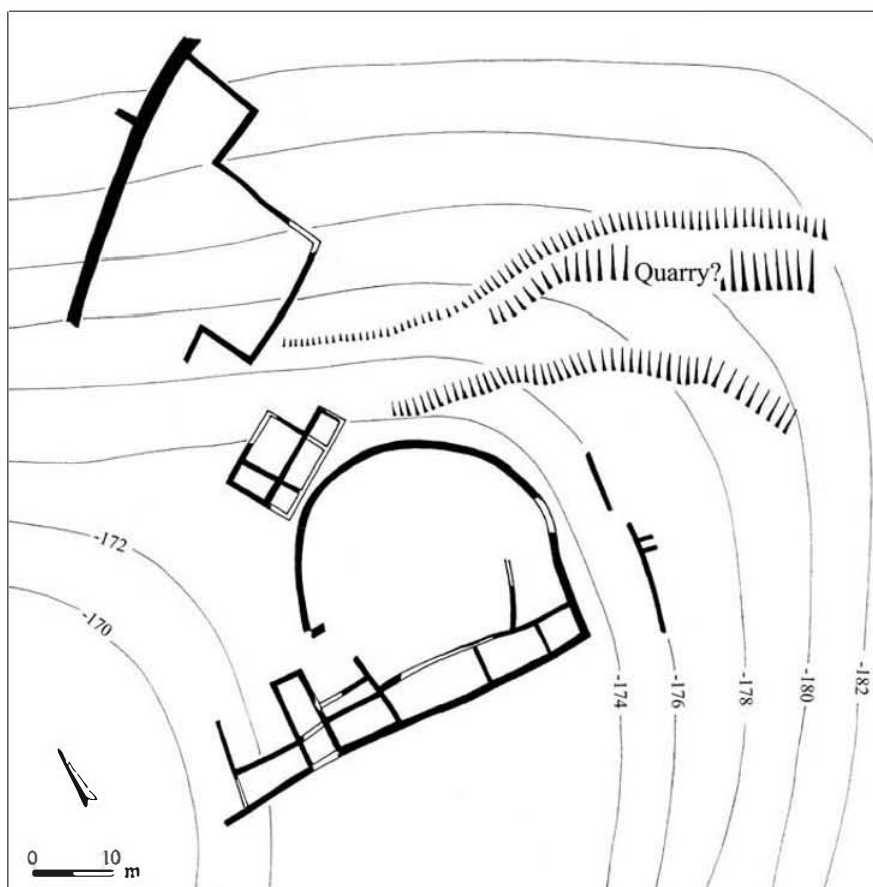
Israel grid: 1945/1735 (centre)
 UTM grid: 7329/56●4
 Elevation: 2●● m b.s.l., 5● m b.s.a.
 Name: nearest place
 Site type: large
 Area: 4●● dunams (4● ha)
 Topography: valley margins
 Rock type: Dead Sea group
 Soil type: brown grumosol

Soil quality: 8
 Cultivation: field crops (partial)
 Cisterns: none
 Water source: Wadi Far'ah (1●4),
 1 km distant
 Road: Jiftlik-Tana (C38),
 next to the site
 Visits: March-April 1995, repeated
 visits 2●●●-2●●2; 35● sherds

This is a very large site, the final extent of which is not yet determined, on the western bank of Wadi Far'ah. The site lies over the connecting land strip between the mountain slopes and the irrigated area of the wadi and the convergence of Wadi Zeith and Wadi Fuleh.

The ancient settlement, located between Mantaket Wadi Zeith in the north and Tell esh-Sheikh Mazar in the south, has two main parts:

1. The northern part stretches across the Wadi Zeith floodplain, a large triangular area draining the mountains: other ravines converge into it. In this place the flood plain is cut by channels of Wadi Zeith, which enabled the construction of the site. In the north of that area were many large courtyards built on platforms 1 m high, built of small stones. Inside the courtyards are the remains of small structures and scatters of single-



159. Partial plan of the south-eastern 'quarter' at Khallet el-Fuleh, 1995. This 'quarter' is a part of the large IB site, which spreads north-west from here over hundreds of dunams.

period IB sherds.

Around the southern channel of Wadi Zeith are more areas with rather dense construction of walls and parts of square structures. Where the wadi had carved deep channels floors and pottery were exposed.

2. The southern part lies in the valley and on the hill of Khallet el-Fuleh. The entire northern slope of the hill was stabilized by terraces on which many structures were sited. On the eastern part of the hill was an enclosure with several complexes of connected structures (see plan in Fig. 159). Most of the structures are square, with rooms measuring 5×5 m. The walls of these structures are built of a single row of large stones or two rows of small ones.

In the same valley were four empty cyst tombs close together, lined with stone slabs. On the northern slope was a round crushing stone, 3 m in diameter and about 1 m thick, still attached to the rock (Fig. 161).

The whole area is covered with great numbers of sherds.

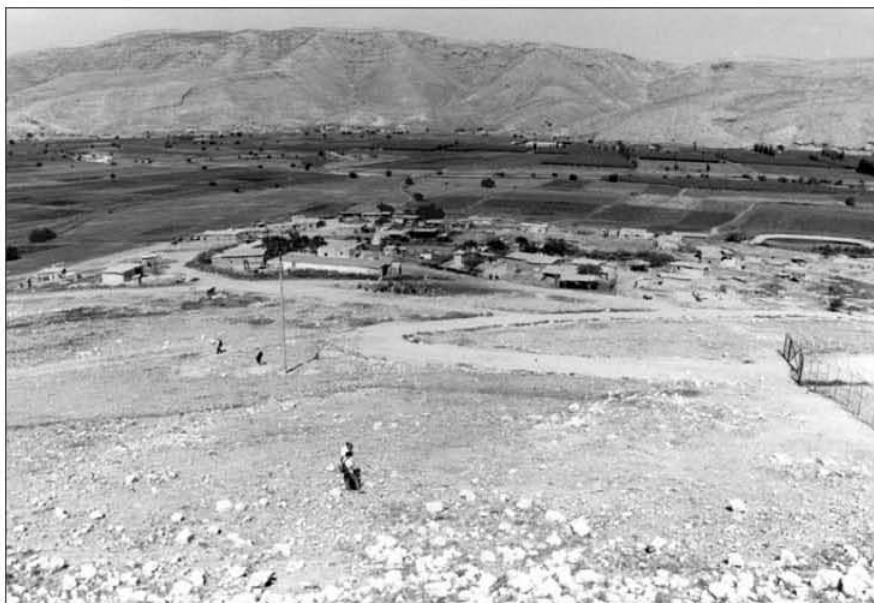
Khallet el-Fuleh is one of the largest IB sites in the Manasseh Hill Country. This central settlement, situated in the west of Wadi Far'ah, includes hundreds of various structures and also slope-strengthening constructions. It was one of the main sites of this period in the Jordan Valley (see Bar 2015b for additional data).

Pottery: Intermediate Bronze – 100%.

Flint: 14 items, IB, see Appendix A.

Stone: 2 installations; a limestone weight and a very large unfinished Rom crushing stone (Eitam 2005: 692-694).

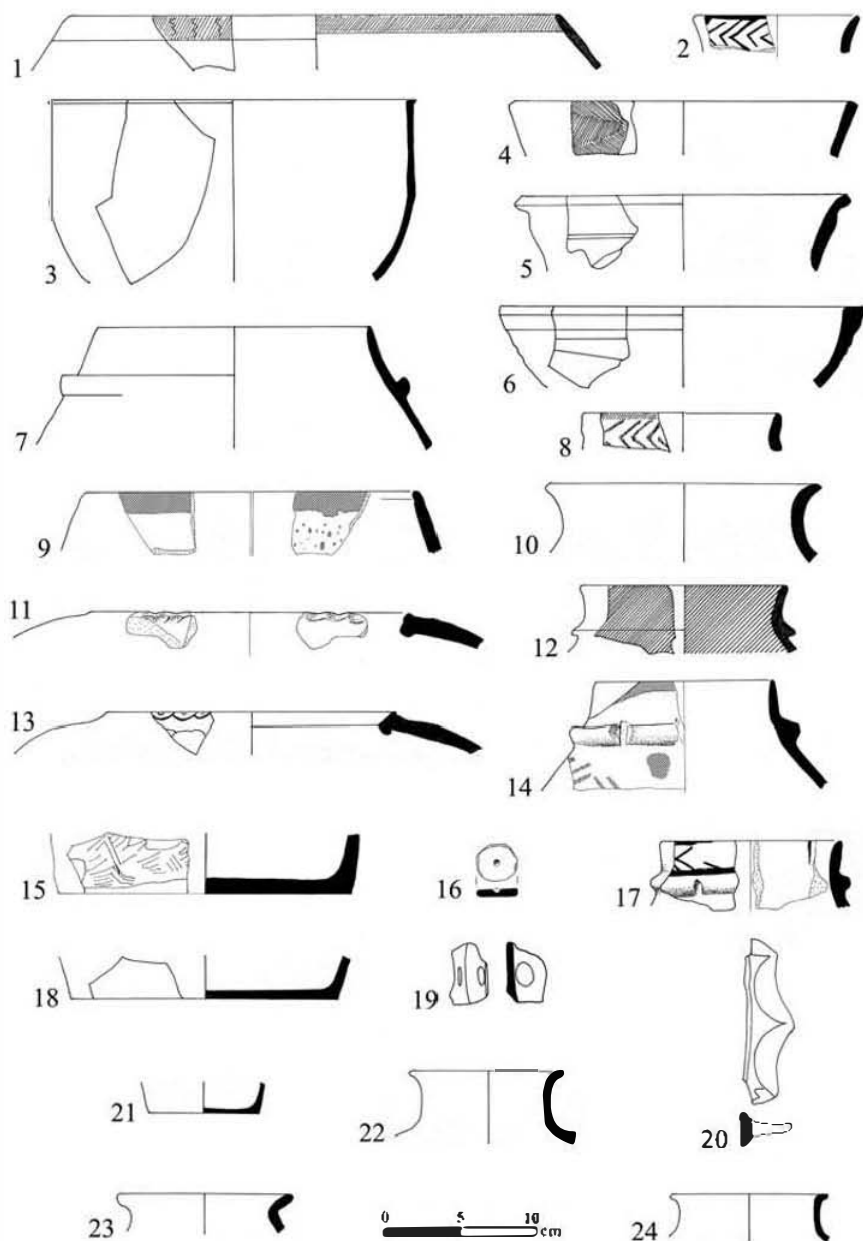
Additional surveys: none.



160. Wadi Far'ab floodplain and Ras Kharubeh ridge (in the background) viewed from Kallet el-Fuleh, view to the north-east, 1995 (A. Zertal).



161. The large unused crushing stone found in the valley of Khallet el-Fuleh, 1995.



162. Pottery from Khallet el-Fuleh, all 1B (buff, well fired, unless described otherwise):

1. HM, rd strip on the rim; 2. Juglet, plastic herring-bone pattern dec; 3. Bowl, gr;
- 4-6, 8. Bowls, rd-dec or incision lines; 7. HM; 9. HM, gr slip; 10, 22-24. Jars; n, 13. HM, finger-impressed rims; 12. Jar, rd slip; 14, 17. Jars, painted dec; 15, 18, 21. Bases; 16. Loom weight; 19. Lug handle; 20. Folded ledge handle.

Site 82: 19-17/51/1

TELL ESH-SHEIKH MAZAR

Israel grid: 1959/1719 (centre)	Soil quality: 4
UTM grid: 7344/5589	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 230 m b.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: ancient and on map	Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104), at the site
Site type: tell	Road: Jiftlik–Tana (C35), next to the site
Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)	Visits: 1992, 2001; 52 sherds
Topography: ridge	
Rock type: Avdat group	
Soil type: stony-desert	

A small site on a spur protruding from the south-west into the Wadi Far'ah floodplain. The semi-derelict British Mandate Jiftlik police building stands on the spur.

On the northern slope of the site is a well-built aqueduct of cemented stones. Its present visible length is about 60 m; its inner side is rock-hewn and the outer side is built. It seems to have carried irrigation water from Wadi Far'ah to the fields. Below the aqueduct and along it, on the northern slope, are supporting walls built of large stones.

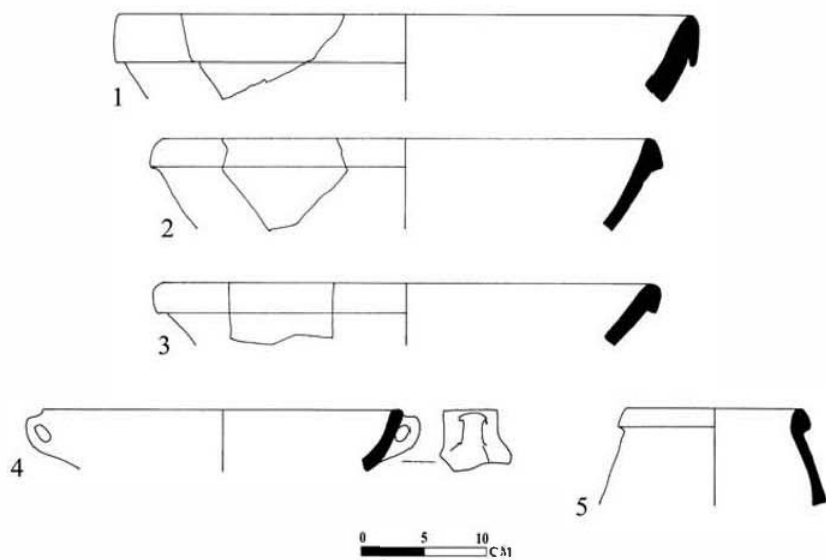
Remains of a stone sarcophagus, broken *in situ*, its narrow panel decorated with laurel and a rosette, were found to the north near the aqueduct. Nearby is a crude sarcophagus-shaped rock, and it is likely that the place served as a quarry for stone sarcophagi.

Construction of the British Mandate police building badly disturbed the ancient remains of the tell; in consequence no wall remains have been traced, and sherds were left scattered over the slopes and around the building.

On March 1874 the British Survey members found burial caves and related them to Tell eṣ-Šimadi [their Tell Mazar, A. Z.]; described as: "The tombs are principally mere caves, but two remain which have *kokim* [burial niches, A. Z.]. One of these has a rude cave-antechamber 22 feet from front to back, from which a masonry door, which has fallen down, opens into the chamber. The door was 1 foot 9 inches wide in the clear, and 3 feet high. Inside is a chamber, with two *kokim* at the back and three on each side-wall (eight in all), rudely cut. Another tomb is simply a grave sunk in the rock, 7 feet long, 2.5 feet wide. On the side was found a tablet, much worn, with letters just traceable, being apparently like the Hebrew of the coins. The rock was so rough that all attempts to take a squeeze of this inscription failed. The letters 𐤒, 𐤔, and 𐤕 are plainly traceable.



163. Aerial view of the British Jiflik Police building built over Tell esh-Sheikh Mazar, view to the west, 2013 (A. Solomon).



164. Pottery from Tell esh-Sheikh Mazar: 1-3. Bowls, lt gr; Pers; 4. Bowl, dk brn, Ir II; 5. Jar, buff, Ir II.

Near this was an unfinished block of stone, probably intended for a sarcophagus cover; and further north was an unfinished sarcophagus. The channel to the mill [probably meaning the aqueduct, A. Z.] (Tahunet el Kadriyeh) is rock-cut, and seems originally, perhaps, to have belonged to an undershot mill, now repaired and altered to an overshot." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 396).

Mellaart (1962: site 76), who surveyed the site, wrote: "Prominent tel, guarding East exit of Wadi Far'ah into Jordan valley about 15-20 m high – small very high citadel and very large skirt on south and west side-grass over-grown. More tombs west of this site in hills. Periods of occupation: IA II, Roman, Byzantine, Medieval."

The Emergency Survey (Bar-Adon 1972, site 3) described it: "Tell west of the road, near the Jiftlik Police building. In the tell is a built and rock-cut aqueduct. Pottery find: from the Early Canaanite, Israelite IIc, Persian and Byzantine periods."

Pottery (summary of the different surveys): Early Bronze; Iron II; Persian; Roman-Byzantine; Middle Ages; Ottoman.

Flint: 9 items, undefined, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: Mellaart 1962: site 76; Bar-Adon 1972: site 3.



Site 83: 19-17/40/1

WADI UMM HAJAR (1)

Israel grid: 1948/1708

UTM grid: 7333/5578

Elevation: 190 m b.s.l., 40 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosures

Area: 3 dunams (3000 sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
1.8 km distant

Road: Jaber-Gittit (C39),
next to the site

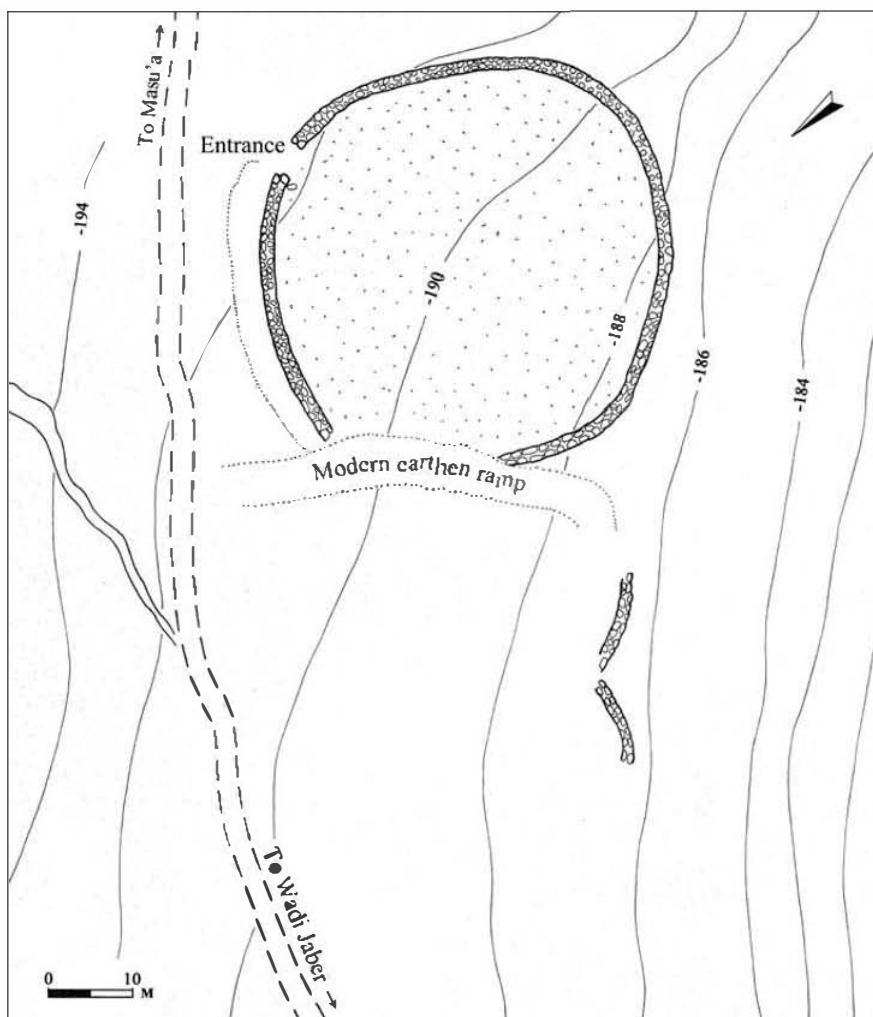
Visits: Feb. 1995, Dec. 2001; 45 sherds

This is a site of enclosures built close to the junction of Wadi Jaber and Wadi Umm Hajar, where they empty into the Wadi Far'ah floodplain. The site is about 2 km north-west of Masu'a.

The enclosures are built along the bottom part of a rocky slope, descend-

ing eastwards from the spur of E.P. -83. Nearby to the East, the unpaved road passes westward from Masu'a along Wadi Jaber. The round enclosure is 45–50 m in diameter, and is encircled by a stone wall, 1 m wide, built of two rows of large stones. In its western part were found several large standing monoliths. The entrance, which is about 1.5 m wide, is in the eastern side of the enclosure. The western part of the enclosure has been covered by a heap of earth from a modern dike.

The remains of the second enclosure, situated west of the former, include



165. Plan of Wadi Umm Hajar (1), 2001.

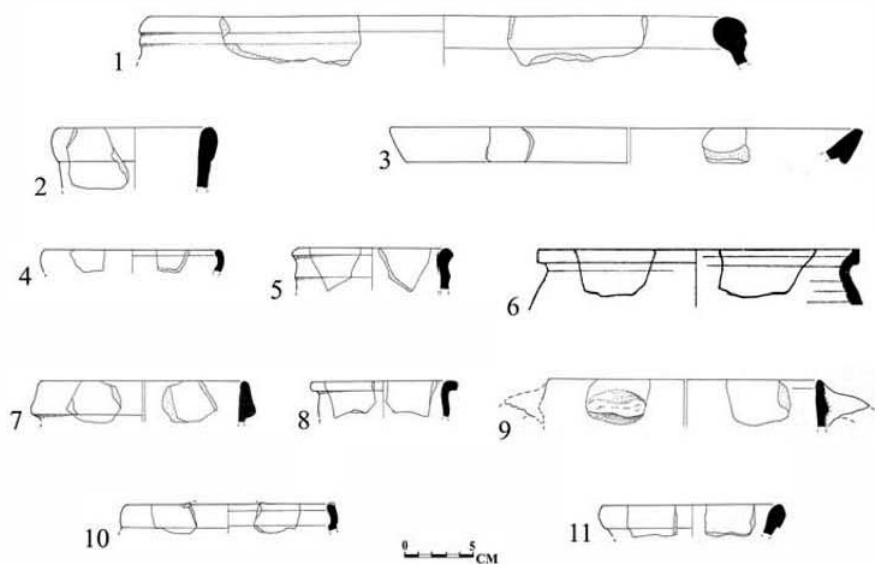
two linked sections of curved walls. The rest of the remains were ruined by the construction of the dike.

The method of construction (two rows of large stones), the period and the location of the site (the Jordan Valley margins), suggest that the site belongs to the large IA enclosures of the region.

Pottery: Iron I – 56%; Iron II – 16%; Late Roman – 24%; Middle Ages – 4%.

Flint: 33 items, IA, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



166. Pottery from Wadi Umm Hajar (1): 1. Krater/CP, dk brn, Ir I-II; 2. Jug, lt brn, Ir I; 3. CP, dk brn, Ir I; 4. Bowl, buff, Ir I; 5. Jar, buff, Ir I; 6-7. CPs, brn, Ir I; 8. Jar, brn, Ir II; 9. Krater, lt brn, LR; 10-11. Jars, gr, MA?

Site 84: 19-17/61/1

TELL EŞ-ŞIMADI

Tell Keraoua in Guérin's publication,

Tell el-Mazar in the British Survey map and in other publications

Israel grid: 1962/1710	Soil quality: 4
UTM grid: 7348/5579	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 226 m b.s.l., 25 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: ancient and on map	Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
Site type: tell	at the site
Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha)	Road: Jaber-Gittit (C39),
Topography: floodplain	500 m distant
Rock type: Dead Sea Group	Visits: March 1983, 2001; 240 sherds
Soil types: silt and marl	

This is a low tell in the centre of the Wadi Far'ah floodplain, between the Shechem-Jiftlik road and the road crossing the wadi floodplain diagonally near Tell esh-Sheik Mazar.

The tell rises about 25 m above the plain, and its eroded slopes are extremely steep in the south and east and more moderate in the north and west. On its top is a square structure, built of large carved stones, measuring 12×12 m. The structure's walls are about 1 m wide, and it is divided internally into rooms. Extensive robbing digs at top of the tell exposed ash layers and sherds, and modern earthmoving destroyed the entrance area (in the south) and left many open trenches.

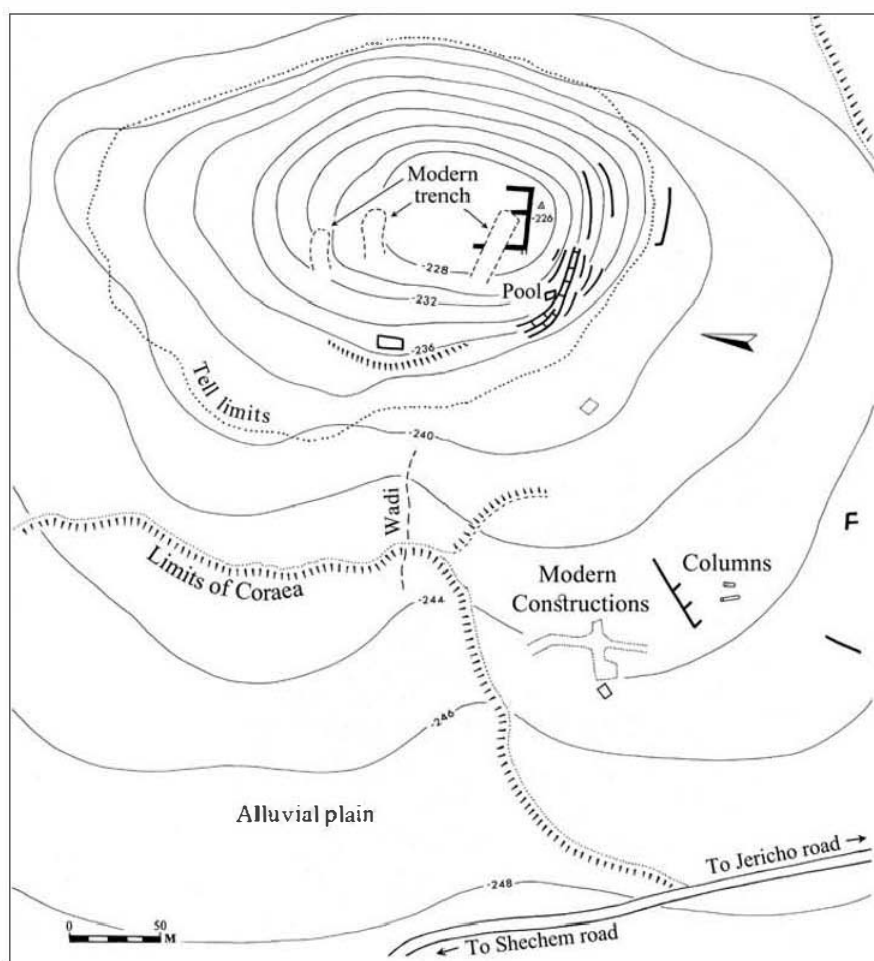
On the southern and western slopes are the remains of many walls; some belong to buildings, and some were probably built for consolidation of the steep slope. On the western slope are a small plastered pool and a structure measuring 10×5 m. At the bottom of the southern slope is a thick wall of large stones, which was perhaps a component of the tell fortifications (a city-wall?).

Over the summit and slopes are scattered an abundance of sherds from the IA and other periods

Guérin (1969: 241) arrived at the site in April 1870, describing it thus: "At 4:35 we crossed Wadi Far'ah. At 4:50 we arrived at Tell Keraoua. It rises gradually, in several stages, from west-north-west to east-south-east. At this edge it overlooks the plain from a height of about 30 m. Its flanks and top are strewn with ceramic fragments and the remains of ruined structures; the lines of several walls are still visible. Some distance west, at the tell's foot, is a *wali* dedicated to Sheikh Abed el-Kader. The Sheikh's tomb is enclosed in a small domed shrine.

In front of this building is a courtyard in which I saw several more Moslem tombs. One of these tombs is adorned with two ancient orthostatic columns, one placed as the deceased's head-rest and the other at his foot. As I have already stated, it is not unacceptable to me that the city of Archelais occupied both the site of Khirbet Makhrug and the site of Tell Keraoua. They are now separated by cornfields and the stream of Wadi El Far'ah."

In the British Survey (March 1874) it is described as: "Kurawa el Mas'udy – This site, which seems to represent the Ancient Archelais, is extensive, and the name seems given rather to the neighbourhood than to any particular ruin. The town seems to have stood at Tell el Mazar, and the cemetery to have been in a rocky ledge 0.5 mile north. The ruins lie all over the tell, especially to the



167. Plan of Tell eṣ-Ṣimadi, and the town of Coraea (Site 85) at its foot, 2001.

south, but when visited were hidden by the mallows. The Arabs spoke of ruins of a church. There are ruined cisterns of masonry lined with cement on the tell, with foundations and pavements of good-sized stones, remains of a considerable town." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 395-396).

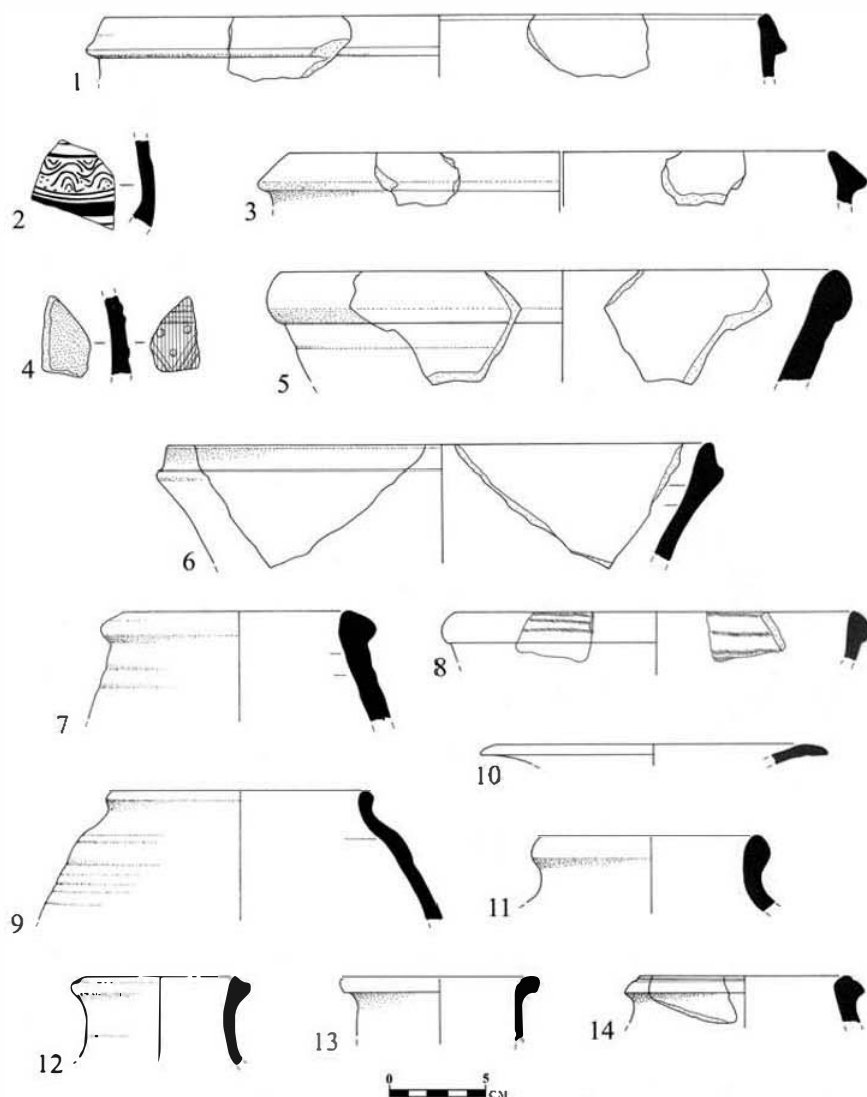
On February 1910 Abel (1913: 227) visited the site: "The maintenance and cultivation of the agricultural areas (in Wadi Far'ah, A. Z.) are done by the Sultan's estate which is called Séraï el-Djiftlik, in charge of the entire side of the wadi. Not far from it is a flour mill with a waterfall and sarcophagus in a quarry [see description of Site 82, A. Z.]. East of it is a *vahy* with a dome, called after Abd el-Rahman son of Abd el-Kader el-Khillani of Baghdad. From its base to the summit of the nearby tell, Tell Mazar [which is Tell eş-Şimadi, A. Z.], are many foundations of structures. Foundations and walls, and remains of ancient trenches, are also found all over the plain. From Tell Mazar, which was the central settlement in the Coraea area, the sight is being only obscured in the south by the high land-block of the Sartaba-Alexandrion."

An expedition from the American School in Jerusalem, headed by Albright, Fisher and Moulton, visited Tell eş-Şimadi in October 1935. This is Moulton's description: "Early on the morning of October 10 last, a party of ten set out in motor cars from the American school in Jerusalem for Qarn Sartabeh... Arriving at the Jiftlik Police Post soon after 8 a. m., we halted for a visit to the mound known today as Tell el-Mazar. This tell lies in a broad plain...and where a perennial rivulet insures good agricultural possibilities. Land in this vicinity



168. Aerial view of Tell eş-Şimadi, looking southwards, 1997 (M. Weinberg).

was cultivated at one time as the private property of the Sultan of Turkey. That Tell el-Mazar represents a site of very early occupation seems certain, even though this fact is not attested by the surface pottery. The summit of the tell and the slopes to the west and south were found to be covered with Arab sherds, some of quite recent date. However, on the northern and eastern slopes there were earlier sherds, that in the judgment of both Drs. Albright and Fisher



169. Pottery from Tell eš-Šimadi: 1, 3. CPs, dk brn, Ir I; 2, 4. Dec sherd, MA; 5. Bowl, dk gr, Pers; 6. Bowl, gr, MA; 7, 9, 11. Jars, buff, Ir I-II; 8. Krater, rd paint, Ir II; 10. Bowl, Byz; 12. Jug, lt brn, Ir I; 13. Jug, brn, Byz; 14. Jar, dk, Ir II.

went back to the period of Iron I and ranged down through the Iron II, Hellenistic, Roman, and Byzantine periods." (Moulton 1936: 14).

Glueck (1951: 418-419), also naming the place Tell el-Mazar, visited it during his survey in 1943 and described it thus: "About 5.25 km to the north east of Qarn Sartabeh.... is Tell el-Mazar (254). It is located in the Jiftlik, near the lower end of the widening plain of the Wadi el-Far'ah, which merges with the plain of the west side of the Jordan Valley. The perennial stream of the Wadi el-Far'ah irrigates not only the arable lands along its sides, but also and especially the rich fields of the merged plains of the Wadi el-Far'ah and the Jordan Valley. Together with its opposite number on the east side of the Jordan, Tell ed-Damieh (200), Tell el-Mazar helps control the important road which leads up into the hill country of Palestine via the Wadi el-Far'ah, and of Transjordan via the Wadi Zerqa (River Jabok)... Viewed from its east side, Tell el-Mazar is an imposing-looking mound, commanding an excellent view over the cultivated Ghor of the west side of the Jordan. The west side of Tell el-Mazar, beyond which the modern track runs, is considerably less steep than the east side. Foundation ruins, many of them probably no earlier than the mediaeval 'Arabic period, are visible on the top of the mound. There are two crude, modern stone houses on the top, and a small mosque. Large quantities of sherds were found on the top and slopes of the mound, most of which belong to the Roman, Byzantine, and mediaeval 'Arabic periods. Tell el-Mazar has generally and probably correctly been identified with the Hellenistic to Byzantine Coreae. There were, in addition, considerable numbers of Iron Age I-II sherds, particularly Iron Age II."

In 1967 Gophna and Porath (1972: site 190) described it thus: "Tell on hill-top. Its slopes are vertical. At its foot, mainly to the south, is a ruin about 100 dunams in area [our Site 85, A.Z.]. In the ruin area are heaps of cut stones, monolithic columns and column bases. Pottery find: over the tell – Early Canaanite, Middle Canaanite II, and Late Canaanite Periods; Israelite I and II; Roman (sigillata), Byzantine, and Middle Ages. In the ruin – Roman-Byzantine (bulk of the find)."

It seems to us that the site served as a fort from IA II, guarding the important crossroad. Similar forts were found at el-Makhruq (2) (Site 73) and in Tell Sheikh Diyab (Zertal 2012a: site 23). The three forts were established over an artificially raised mound, serving as a podium, and should be considered as components of the fortification system of the Israelite Kingdom.

Pottery: Early Bronze II – 5%; Middle Bronze IIB – 5%; Iron I – 10%; Iron II – 40%; Iron III – 5%; Persian – 15%; Byzantine – 10%; Early Moslem – 5%; Middle Ages – 5%.

Identification: see Chapter 2.

Additional surveys: Glueck 1951: site 254; Gophna and Porath 1972: site 190.

Site 85: 19-17/60/1

QARAWET ET-TAHTA

In the British Survey map Kurawa el-Mas'udy

Israel grid: 1962/1708	Soil quality: 4
UTM grid: 7347/5578	Cultivation: partial (vegetables)
Elevation: 215 m b.s.l., 0 m b.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: ancient and on map	Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
Site type: large	700 m distant
Area: 100 dunams (10 ha)	Road: Jaber–Gittit (C39),
Topography: floodplain	400 m distant
Rock type: Dead Sea Group	Visit: March 1983; 121 sherds
Soil types: Lisan marl and silt	

A vast site over a plain in the centre of a floodplain in Wadi Far'ah, surrounding Tell eṣ-Ṣimadi from the south, west and east. The site is between Wadi Far'ah in the north and the road crossing the plain and connecting the Shechem–Jiftlik and Jericho–Beit She'an roads. In the western part of the site, north of Tell eṣ-Ṣimadi is a modern cemetery.

The city bounds are clearly visible, and stand about 2 m above the floodplain. Certain signs, mainly the remains of a straight street in the western part and stone columns, testify that this was a planned Rom-Byz city. Earthworks, agricultural cultivation, destruction by the local population and the abundant silt covered and obscured the ancient remains.

In the western part near the road were remains of walls and structures, and hard chalk smoothed columns. In the vicinity are also squares paved with small stones, seemingly remains of a military camp – Ottoman, British or Jordanian.

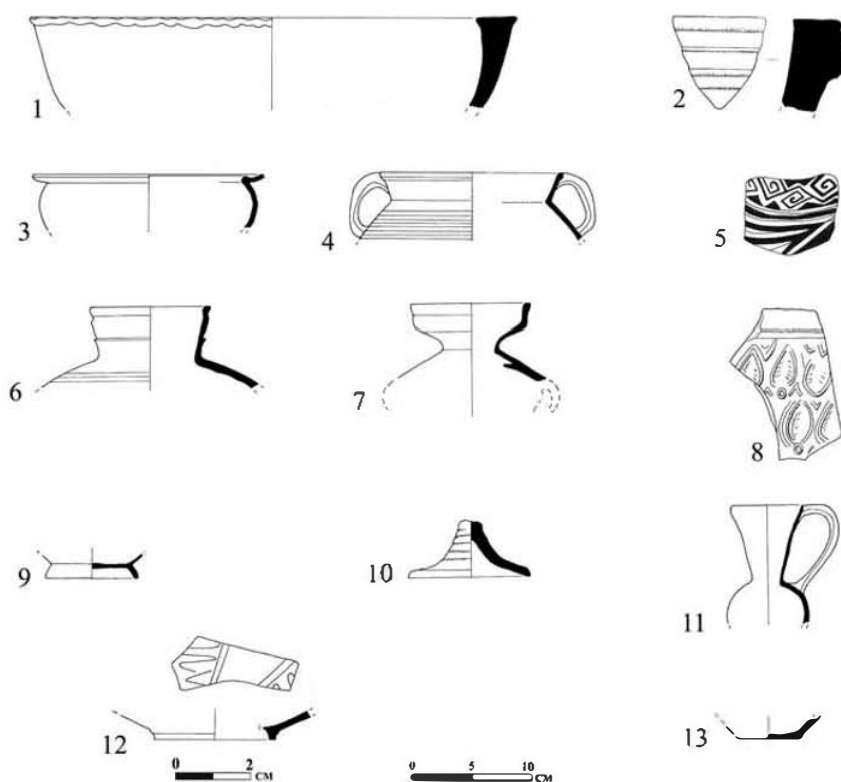
During the Emergency Survey (Gophna and Porath 1972: site 190): "Concentrations of cut stones, monolithic columns and pillar bases" were found here. An engraved stone was found in the city ruins.

In February 1910 Abel (1913: 227–229) reported: "Corea and Alexandrion were probably meeting points at a certain historical moment. The necropolis of Corea is in the plain and hills west of the farm. Private digs [robbing! A. Z.] exposed burial caves, and particularly a lead sarcophagus, which the Arabs melted for the purpose of manufacturing rifle rounds. The caves at the foot of the hill are natural, and inside them two graves were hewn..." Afterwards, Abel notes the agricultural advantages of the place and the road network.

The identification with the city of Coraea, which is mentioned several times by Josephus and also appears in the Madaba Map, is beyond doubt. No other site fits this identification; the place and period are well suited (see identifica-

tions Chapter 2). The name (Qaraweh) has been well preserved here, and Tell eṣ-Ṣimadi is located at the centre of the ancient city.

Coraea is first mentioned in Pompey's expedition in 63 BCE. Josephus (War I, vi: 5) writes: "Indignant at this behaviour, and yielding to the urgent entreaties of Hyrcanus and his friends, Pompey started in pursuit of Aristobulus, with the Roman forces and a large contingent of Syrian auxiliaries. Passing Pella and Scythopolis, he reached Coreae, at which point a traveller ascending through the interior enters the territory of Judaea. There he heard that Aristobulus had taken refuge in Alexandreion..." The city is mentioned for the second time in the description of Aspasianus' war expedition in 66 CE (War IV, viii: 1): "He



170. Pottery from Qarawet et-Tahta: 1. Bowl, lt gr, plastic dec, MA; 2. Sherd, plastic dec, brn, Byz; 3. Bowl, lt brn, Hel-ER; 4. CP, brn, ER; 5. Sherd, violet over cream, MA (Mamluk); 6. Jar, lt brn, LR; 7. Jug, brn, ER; 8. Sherd, gr, impression dec, EM (Umayyad); 9. Bowl base, brn, LR; 10. Lid, brn, ER; 11. Juglet, gr, EM; 12. Bowl base, engraving over glazing, MA; 13. Bowl base, EM.

then returned with the rest of his forces to Ammaus, and thence by way of Samaria, passing Neapolis or, as the natives call it, Mabartha, he descended to Corea, where he encamped on the second of the month Daesius. On the following day he reached Jericho..."

The British Survey members described the site (see their description of Tell eṣ-Ṣimadi, Site 84) and suggested identifying it as Archelais (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 395-396). All the other scholars identified it as Coraea.

Pottery: Early Roman – 15%; Late Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 40%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 15%.

Additional surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972: 190.

Additional Bibliography: Guérin 1969: 241.



171. Traditional clay brick houses in Qaraweh plain, 2000 (M. Einav).

Site 86: 19-16/59/1

RUJM ES-SI'A

In the British Survey – Rujm es-Saigh and in Guérin – Kharbet Kerzeleia

Israel grid: 1956/1693	Soil quality: 3
UTM grid: 7342/5563	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: ancient but not on map	Water source: 'Ein Jeruzaliyeh (172), 1.5 km distant
Site type: fort	Road: Coraea–Sartaba (C43), next to the site
Area: 7.5 dunams (7500 sq. m)	Visits: Nov. 1993, 2001; 27 sherds
Topography: spur	
Rock type: Avdat Group	
Soil type: stony-desert	

A fort on a low spur (Rujm es-Si'a) extending from the Wadi Jeruzaliyeh ridge eastward to the Jordan Valley, about 600 m west of the northern edge of Masu'a. Next to it passes a paved road entering the eastern part of Wadi Jeruzaliyeh. There is a good view to Wadi Far'ah and Wadi Jeruzaliyeh.

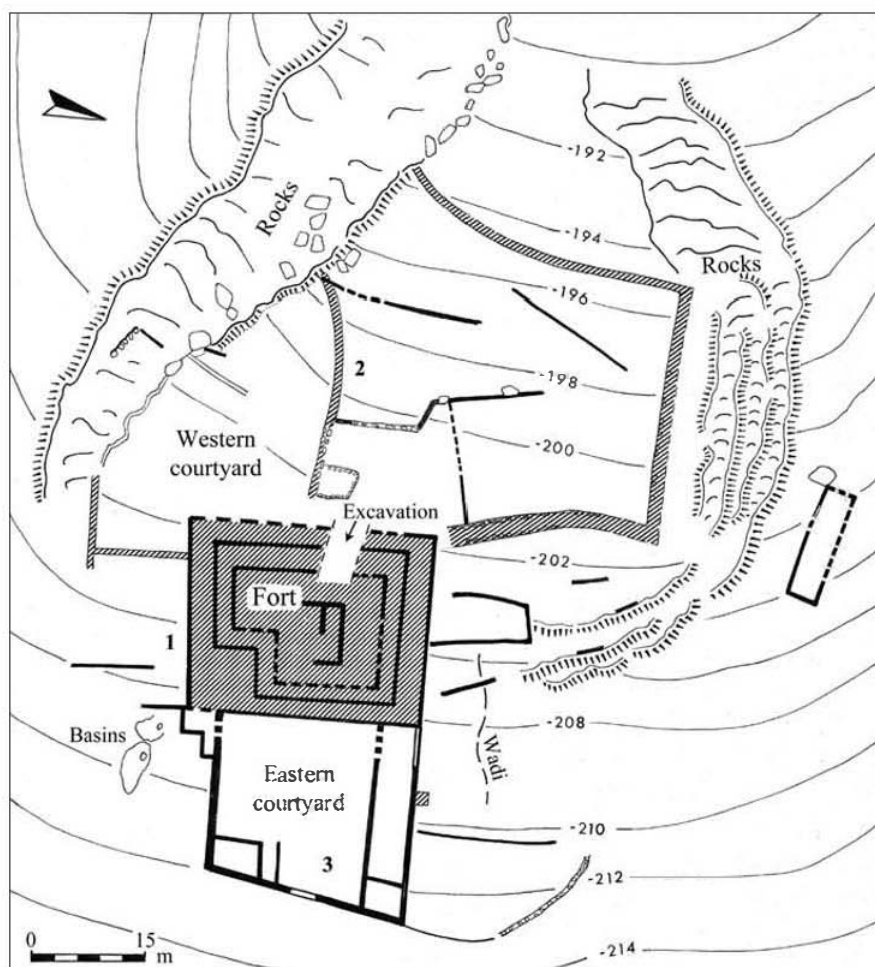
The site has three main parts: The fort, the western courtyard and the eastern area.

1. The fort is a trapezoidal structure measuring 29×20 m, built of large cut stones and connected to courtyards in the east and west. It rises about 6 m above the low hilltop on which it is built. The structure is irregular, its walls are straight, and it contains three structures, one inside the other – each one is taller and narrower than the one outside it, forming a stepped tower. The two outer steps were probably built to support the inner tower, which is L-shaped. The place was robbed or otherwise excavated, but not published, and the western part was bulldozed. In the upper part two rooms with well-built walls of cut stones were exposed. Two walls parallel to those of the fort are visible inside.
2. The larger western courtyard, 70×70 m, has an irregular shape, and its corners connect to the corners of the fort. The courtyard walls are particularly thick (up to 2.5 m) and on its southern side it meets a low rocky cliff. In the courtyard area are various walls and an oval structure attached to the southern wall.
3. The eastern courtyard, the smaller of the two, is trapezoidal, and adjoins the fort to the east. Its corners connect to the corners of the fort where the latter widen out. It measures approximately 25×25 m, and the northern and southern walls are double casemate walls, but only one of the inner partitions survived.

A support wall projects southward from the south-eastern corner of the fort. Next to it, in the east, are two rock-cut installations.

Guérin (1969: 243) visited the site while climbing the Sartaba in April 1870, describing it thus: “we arrived at a ruined site named *Khæbet Kerzeleia* at the top of a rocky hill. It was surrounded by a wall built of large uncut stones, traces of which are still visible. In the lower part of this hill, at the southern corner, are the remains of several ruined dwellings, and between them are two rock-hewn cisterns. The stones which were used for the construction of the village are hard, black and porous; they are almost worked.” Guérin correctly identified the fort and the western courtyard, which is built of large stone blocks.

In 1874 the British Survey described it: “Rujm es Saigh – A ruined tower by



172. Plan of Rujm es-Si'a, 2001.

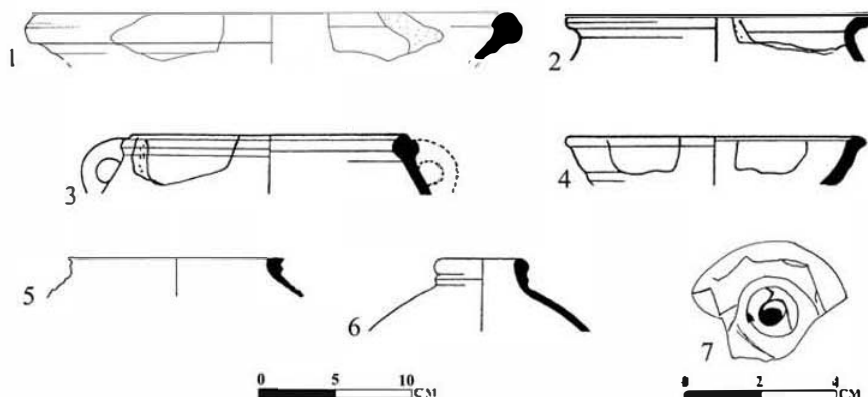
a spring, commanding the valley; possibly of crusading date.” (Conder and Kitchen 1882: 4●3).

It can be assumed that this fort, which was built in the Roman period over an IA site, guarded the entrance to Wadi Jeruzaliyeh, and protected one of the important roads ascending to the Sartaba, belonging to the outer fortification system encircling it. Another site of similar nature with courtyards is ‘Ein Abu Daraj (Site 154), that guards the approach to the Sartaba from the north-west. The site at Elevation Point 105 (Site 168) probably also belongs to this system.

Pottery: Iron I-II – 15%; Early Roman – 21%; Late Roman – 15%; Byzantine –



173. The fort at Rujm es-Si'a, view to the north, 2003 (M. Einav).



174. Pottery from Rujm es-Si'a: 1. Bowl, brn, ER; 2. CP, Ir I; 3. CP, brn, Ir II; 4. Bowl, gr, Ir II; 5. Bowl, pk, Rom; 6. Jar, dk brn, Ir II; 7. Lid, LR.

18%; Early Moslem – 31%.

Flint: 87 items, Upper Palaeolithic, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 87: 19-16/48/1

WADI EJ-JERUZALIYEH

In the British Survey W. el-Kurzeleiyeh

Israel grid: 1949/1689

UTM grid: 7334/5558

Elevation: 140 m b.s.l., 40 m b.s.a.

Name: ancient, but not on map

Site type: structures and enclosures

Area: 14 dunams (1.4 ha)

Topography: low spurs

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Jeruzaliyeh (172),
1 km distant

Road: Coraea–Sartaba (C43),
next to the site

Visit: Oct. 1993; 44 sherds

This site spreads across the narrow part of Wadi Jeruzaliyeh, which descends from the Sartaba to the Wadi Far'ah floodplain. There is a limited view from the place to Wadi Far'ah and to the Jordan Valley plain.

The site is close to the north of the wadi's deep channell, and is located on the spurs separating the wadi from the ridges north of it. It has two parts:

1. An oval courtyard, built of large stones, and measuring 19×17 m. In the eastern part is a built entrance, 70 cm wide; at the south-east it meets a wall, 7 m long. 10 m east of the yard is a rectangular structure (9×6 m), finely built of large stones with an opening at the north-east.

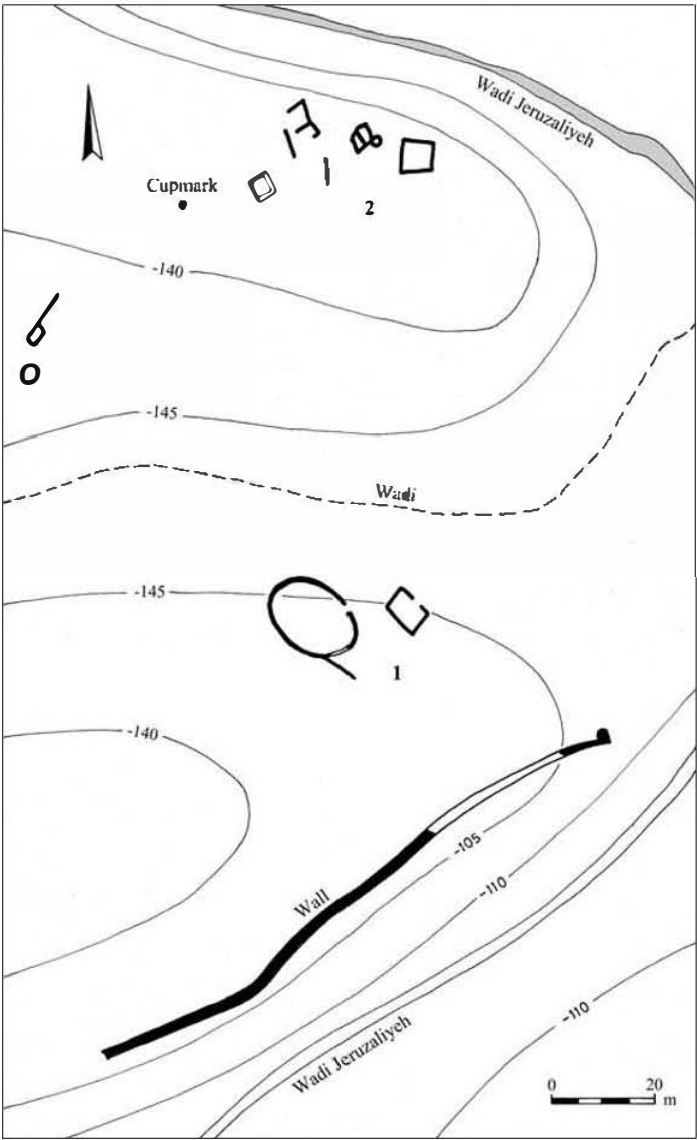
South of the enclosure and the structure, along the low slope of the spur and along the wadi, is a wall about 110 m long, terminating on the east with a tower-like structure. The wall is 80 cm thick and is built along the channel; its function is not clear.

2. About 100 m north of the oval courtyard, over a spur across a shallow stream channel, is a cluster of structures. It includes houses of various sizes scattered over the spur. All the walls are one stone thick (50–60 cm). Among the square structures are also some rounded ones, 2–3 m in diameter, attached to each other.

The settlement in Wadi Jeruzaliyeh includes enclosures and dwelling houses; it

was established in the IA II, and the habitation continued later. It is likely that it was linked to the nearby spring ('Ein Jerisaliyeh) and to the path ascending through it to the Sartaba fort.

Pottery: Iron II – 36%; Late Roman – 39%; Early Moslem – 25%.
Additional surveys: none.



175. Plan of Wadi ej Jeruzaliyeh, 1992.



176. 'Ein Jeruzaliyeh, view to the south, 1993. The spring source has been covered with corrugated iron sheets by the Bedouin in order to prevent the flock from stampeding (S. Hashman).



177. The enclosures in Wadi ej-Jeruzaliyeh view to the south, 1993 (A. Zertal).

Site 88: 19-16/58/1

EL-MUDARAJ (2)

Israel grid: 1957/1688	Soil quality: 4
UTM grid: 7343/5558	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 40 m b.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: nearest place	Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104), 2 km distant
Site type: enclosure	Road: Coraea–Sartaba (C43), next to the site
Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)	Visit: Oct. 1993; 52 sherds
Topography: valley margins	
Rock type: silt cover	
Soil type: stony-desert	

An oval enclosure where the southern part of Wadi Jeruzaliyeh merges into the Jordan Valley, adjacent and below the ridge bordering the wadi, 150 m west of Masu'a.

The enclosure measures 55 m (north-west to south-east axis) by 50 m (north-east to south-west), with walls built two rows of medium-sized stones, about 1 m wide; in some sections it is up to 1.5 m thick. Average stone measurements are 40×40 cm. Large stones are embedded in the wall in several places. The opening was not found.

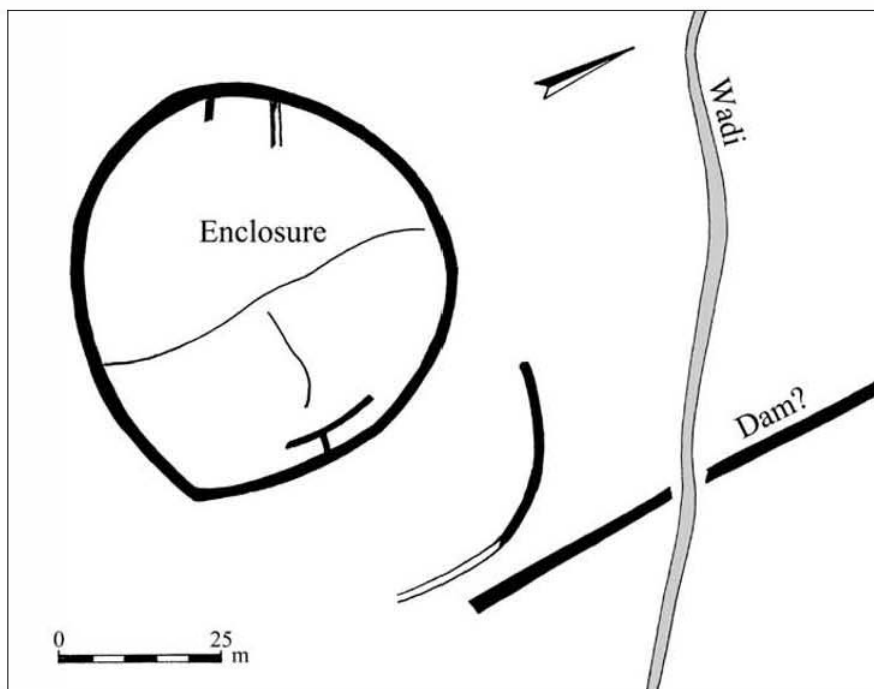
The enclosure is divided by a thin crooked wall, generally oriented north-south; from which starts a wall going eastward, splitting the eastern enclosure into two. Several short walls which might have been parts of buildings protrude into the enclosure. Such a building perhaps remained in the eastern part of the enclosure. Another wall was found here, parallel to the inside of the enclosure wall.

About 25 m north-east of the enclosure is another curved wall, 60 cm wide, parallel to the enclosure, but not connected to it. A wall crosses the wadi river-bed at right angles about 35 m east of the enclosure. The length of this wall (a dam?) is about 60 m.

Pottery: Iron I – 28%; Late Roman – 66%; Modern – 6%.

Stone: 9 items including 5 basalt manos, 2 limestone burnishers, a lower basalt grinding stone and beach rock mano, mostly dated to the IA (Eitam 2005: 694-695).

Additional surveys: none.



178. Plan of el-Mudaraj (2), 1993.



Site 88 (1): 2●-17/●9/2

EL-MUDARAJ (3)

Israel grid: 2●●9/1792

UTM grid: 7393/5663

Elevation: 1●● m b.s.l., 1●● m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: sherd scatter

Area: 1 dunam (1●●● sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Nari

Soil type: rendzina

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Saleh (17●),
1.2 km distantRoad: Beit She'an-Jericho (B1●),
9●● m distant

Visit: Nov. 2●15; 3● sherds

A small sherd scatter and agricultural terraces on an eastern slope of E.P. -7 above tributaries of Wadi el-Mudaraj, 5●● m south-west of the LR fortress at Khirbet el-Gharur (Zertal 2●●8: site 259), and 5 km south of Hemdat. There are fine views of the Jordan Valley.

The site might be part of the agricultural hinterland of the Khirbet el-Gharur LR fortress.

Pottery: Late Roman-Byzantine – 100%.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 89: 19-16/67/2

MASU'A (1)

Israel grid: 1962/1675

UTM grid: 7348/5545

Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 25 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosure and caves

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
2.8 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
300 m distant

Visit: Jan. 1993; 34 sherds

An enclosure with pottery and flint scatters in an inner valley, where the eastern slopes of the Sartaba range merge with the Jordan Valley, about 400 m west of Masu'a.

Over the slope north of the riverbed, and across it, are two terraces, presumably support walls, about 30 m apart, built of stones of various sizes. The enclosure is located below the bottom terrace. The enclosure walls reach to a low cliff. Many flint items were collected in the enclosure and the terrace surfaces.

South-west, across the riverbed, about 60–80 m from the enclosure, are two dwelling caves. The southern wall by the cave entrances is built of non-uniform size stones. The cave ceilings are lower than a man's height. In the upper part of the riverbed, west of the site, are scatters of flint items. This scatter extends on both sides of the riverbed. Over the slope, below the dwelling caves, are scattered a few Byzantine period sherds.

Pottery: Chalcolithic – 80%; Byzantine – 20%; only body sherds.

Flint: 93 items, Chalcolithic, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.

Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 69.

Site 9●: 19-16/67/4

MASU'A (5)

Israel grid: 1966/1673

UTM grid: 7353/5543

Elevation: 255 m b.s.l., ● m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: courtyards

Area: 2.5 dunams (25●● sq. m)

Topography: plain

Rock type: silt

Soil type: silt

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

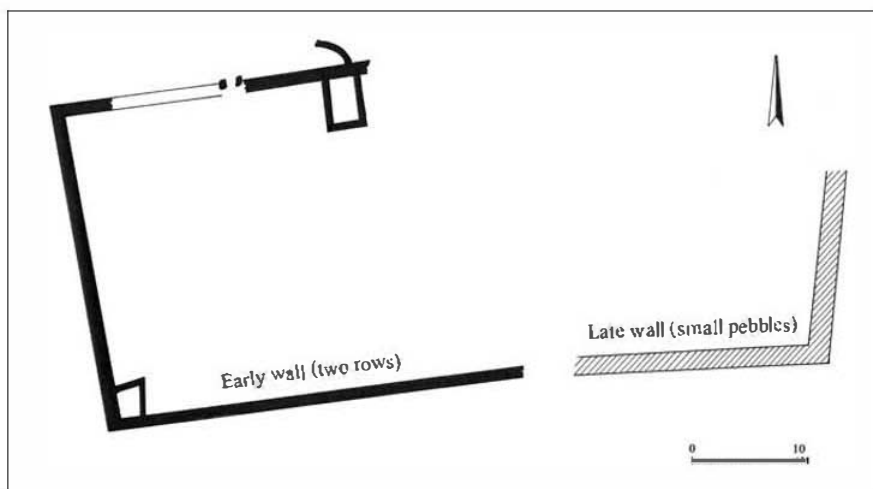
Water source: Wadi Far'ah (1●4),
2.3 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B1●),
next to the site

Visit: Jan. 1993; 41 sherds

A rectangular courtyard in the Wadi Masu'a (Wadi Habeij) outlet, in the eastern and wide part of the wadi valley and about 1●● m west of the Jordan Valley regional packing-house.

The site is 65 m long by 3● m wide, having two parts:

1. In the western part of the site is a courtyard measuring 4●×3● m. Its straight walls are 1 m wide, built of two rows of large cut stones. In its northern part is an opening between two upright standing stones, and a small adjacent room, 6×3 m in size with walls 4● cm thick.
2. The eastern part, measuring 24×19 m, is built as an extension of the western one, with a slight change of orientation. The wall here is built of small stones and is about 2 m wide. This phase differs from the former: it was



179. Plan of Masu'a (5), 1993.

built to the same plan, but is later in time. It was perhaps an alteration and widening of the original enclosure.

A probable reconstruction of the place past yields a first phase (Byz?), in which a large meticulously built courtyard was established. After it was partly demolished, the site was restored and extended eastward, doubling its area.

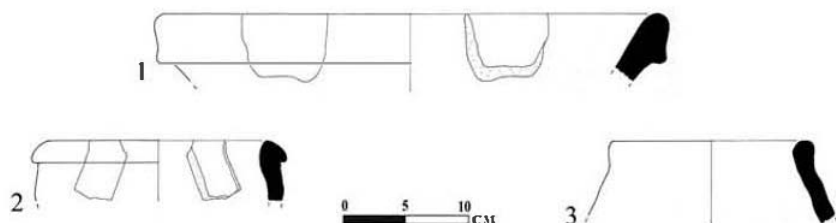
Pottery: Byzantine – 50%; Early Moslem – 25%; Middle Ages – 25%.

Flint: 28 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



180. The Masu'a plain and part of the wall at Masu'a (5), view to the north, 1993.
In the background is the Wadi Far'ah floodplain.



181. Pottery from Masu'a (5): 1. Bowl, lt gr, MA; 2. Jar, brn, Byz; 3. Jar, buff, EM.

Site 90 (1): 19-16/67/5

ED-DIRS

Israel grid: 1968/1675

UTM grid: 7353/5545

Elevation: 256 m b.s.l., 15 m b.s.a.

Site type: sherd scatter

Area: 20 dunams (2 ha)

Topography: hill

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
2.3 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10), next
to the site

The Emergency Survey team (Bar-Adon 1972: site 6) noted a site on a stony hill destroyed by modern constructions. The site no longer exists, and is probably buried below the Jordan Valley Regional Council's buildings.

Pottery (in the Emergency Survey): Roman; Early Moslem.

Additional surveys: Bar-Adon 1972: site 6.



Site 91: 19-16/67/1

MASU'A (2)

Israel grid: 1961/1671

UTM grid: 7347/5541

Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 50 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: large and enclosures

Area: 25 dunams (2.5 ha)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
3 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
1 km distant

Visit: Jan. 1993; 52 sherds

A large settlement, with many structures and enclosures, on the western step of Masu'a Valley, about 500 m south-west of the Jordan Valley Regional Council buildings.

The place includes two enclosures, remains of structures and a tumulus. The distance between the enclosures is 100 m; the diameter of both is about 20 m.

1. The southern enclosure is rather ruined. In its western wall is an entrance between two monoliths. The construction is good, of a single row of large stones.

2. The northern enclosure is oval, also with an apparent opening, and two internal partition walls.

About 20 m south of the northern enclosure is a round structure, 4 m in diameter, built of particularly large stones; apparently a tumulus.

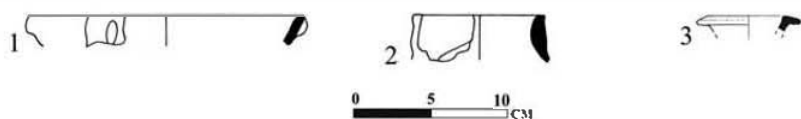
In the enclosure area can be seen remains of walls, indicating dwellings. Due to the thick sedimentation over the site it is difficult to discern their plans.

Pottery: Chalcolithic (?) – 80%; Late Roman – 20%; mostly small body sherds.

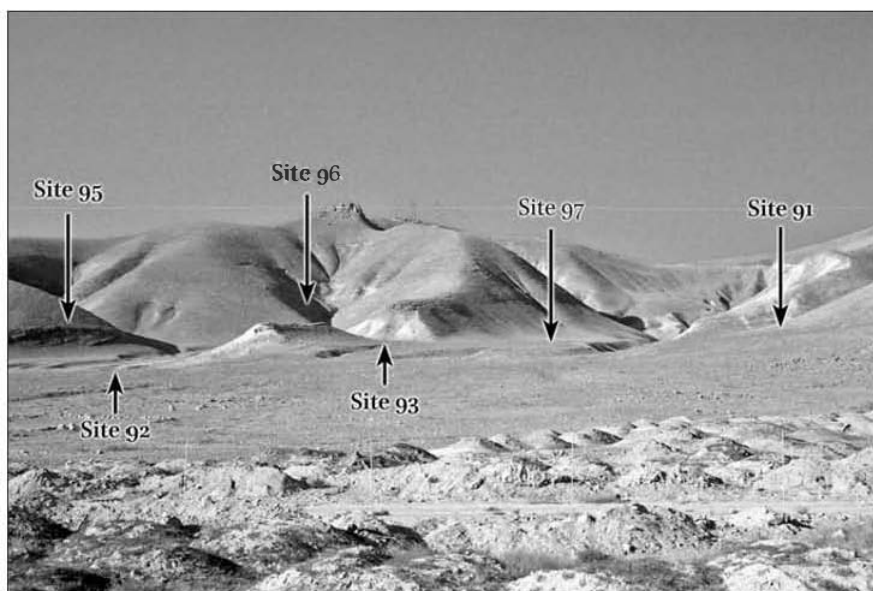
Flint: 85 items, Chalcolithic, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.

Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 70.



182. Pottery from Masu'a (2): 1. Bowl, cream, Chal?; 2. Jar, lt brn, LR; 3. Juglet, lt brn, LR.



183. The Masu'a Valley with the locations of the various sites, view to the south-west, 2003 (M. Einav).

Site 92: 19-16/66/3

MASU'A (4)

Israel grid: 1964/1668

UTM grid: 7350/5538

Elevation: 230 m b.s.l., 0 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 4 dunams (4000 sq. m)

Topography: plain

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
3 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
700 m distant

Visits: Feb. 1993, 2002; 22 sherds

A large and complex enclosure in the central part of the Masu'a Valley, close to the Wadi Masu'a channel (Wadi Habeij).

The enclosure is about 105 m long and about 45 m wide. A section of the southern wall has been washed away and only few walls have been preserved; however, it is still possible to learn the site's scheme from the remaining northern half.

The enclosure, 'sandal- or 'foot-shaped', was encircled by a wall 1.1 m wide, built of two rows of large stones, measuring on average 60×50 cm. In most places only the lower course survived, but occasionally two courses survived, meaning that the encircling wall stood to that height at least.

The northern wall is shaped like the sole of a sandal, because of its concave central part, forming the unique outline of two integrated oval enclosures. Along the north-eastern part of the site, which is the eastern part of the 'sandal', were located a few sections of inner walls parallel to the outer one; that perhaps indicate inner rooms in a casemate form.

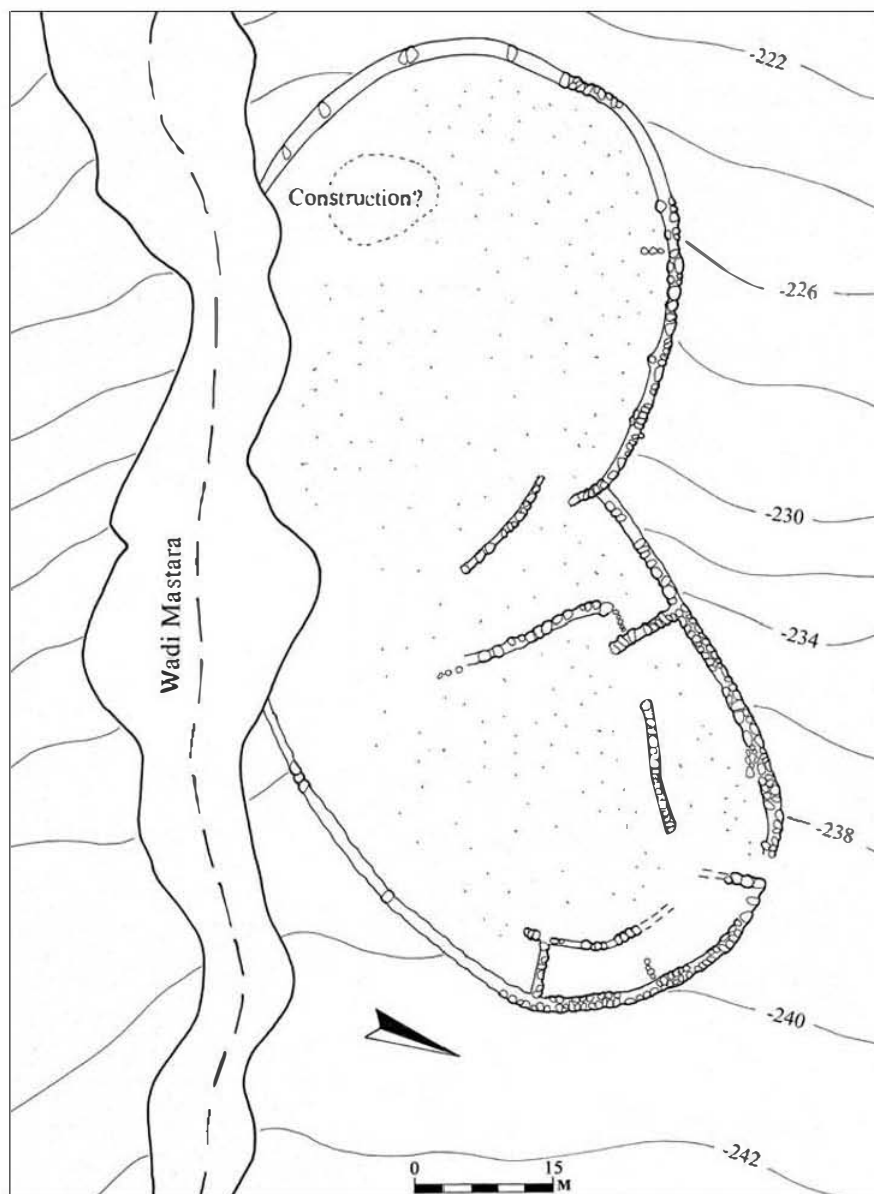
Inside the enclosure were found sections of various walls, built one stone wide. These walls may have divided the enclosure into quarters, but this requires additional research. The location of the entrance is unknown; possibly it was where the wall terminates in the north-eastern part. The site was subjected to erosion, and the number of sherds is not great, but the dating to the IA I is certain.

The site is similar in location and nature to the sites Bedhat esh-Sha'ab (Site 65) and Yafit (3) (Site 105). It is possible that the present site belongs to the encampment type (*Gilgal*) sites of IA I, with their unique shape (see Chapter 1 Sections D and E).

Pottery: Iron I – 100%.

Flint: 3 items, see Appendix A.

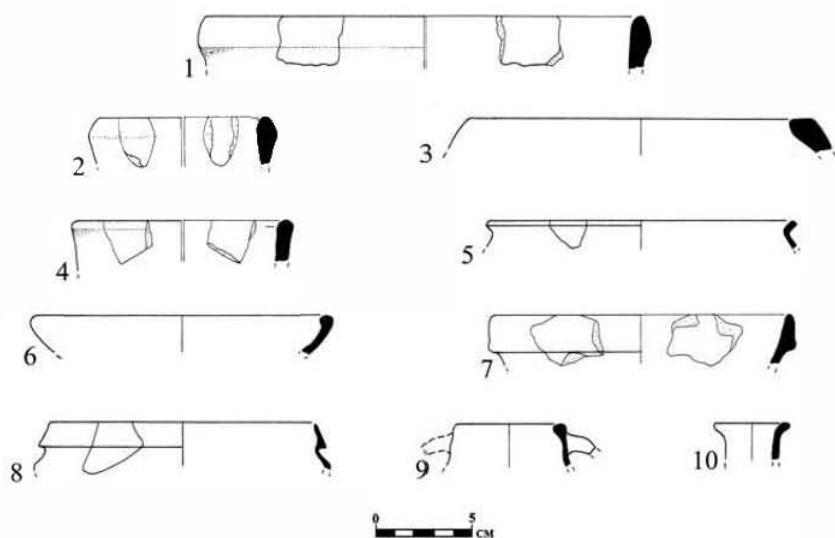
Additional surveys: none.



184. Plan of Masu'a (4), 1993.



185. Aerial view of Masu'a (4), view to the north-west, 2013 (A. Solomon).



186. Pottery from Masu'a (4), all Ir I: 1. Krater, dk brn; 2. Jug, lt brn; 3. Krater, dk brn; 4. Jar, lt brn; 5, 8. CPs, dk brn; 6. 'Manasseh' bowl, lt brn; 7. CP, brn; 9. Jug, gr; 10. Juglet, lt brn.

Site 93: 19-16/66/1

E.P. -189

Israel grid: 1961/1669

UTM grid: 7347/5538

Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: large

Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)

Topography: narrow valley

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
3 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
1 km distant

Visits: Jan. 1993, May 2001; 45 sherds

A site in a valley descending eastward from the Sartaba range emptying into the Jordan Valley, near the channel of Nahal Masu'a (Wadi Habeij), and 600 m south-west of the Jordan Valley Regional Council compound.

The site structures are scattered over a narrow spur between the prominent hill of E.P. -189 and el-Mastara hills and on the southern bank of Wadi Habeij.



187. The western cliff at E.P. -189 and the 6×6 m structure on the slope, view to the east, 2003 (M. Einav). See plan in Site 97 ahead.



188. Pottery from E.P. -189: 1. CP, dk brn, Ir I; 2. 'Manasseh' bowl, lt brn, Ir I.

Along a 150 m stretch were found foundations of many structures, scattered walls, sherds, tents bases, tumuli and other remains.

In the eastern part of the site, on the western side of E.P. -189, is a 6×6 m structure with the western wall missing, built of large stones. From the top of the hill a wall about 65 m long (up to the channel) and 1.5 to 3 m wide, descends northward. A 10×8 m tower-like structure projects eastwards from the centre of the wall. The wall crosses the channel northward, and extends another 65 m, terminating close to the main channel of Wadi Habeij (see Fig. 195).

The northern wall is unique and raises many questions. We could not find parallels to a wall with a tower, which crosses a valley anywhere else in the region. Its purpose – agricultural or a flood-damming – is uncertain. If its function was as a component in an agricultural crop-raising system, then it would have been reasonable to find similar arrangements elsewhere. Perhaps it meant to serve for defence, but the fact that the south of the site remained open precludes such a function.

Pottery: Early Bronze I (?) – 11%; Iron I – 24%; Late Roman – 58%; Middle Ages – 7%.

Flint: 10 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 94: 19-16/66/2

MASU'A (8)

Israel grid: 1963/1668

UTM grid: 7349/5537

Elevation: 210 m b.s.l., 20 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: slope and valley margins

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
2.8 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
800 m distant

Visit: Feb. 1993; 63 sherds

This is an enclosure on the southern slope of E.P. -189, in Nahal Masu'a (Wadi Habeij), about 1.5 km south of Masu'a.

The E.P.-189 hill is prominent in the centre of the valley, which has many rivulets and ditches crossing the floodplain. The enclosure is 10 m in diameter,

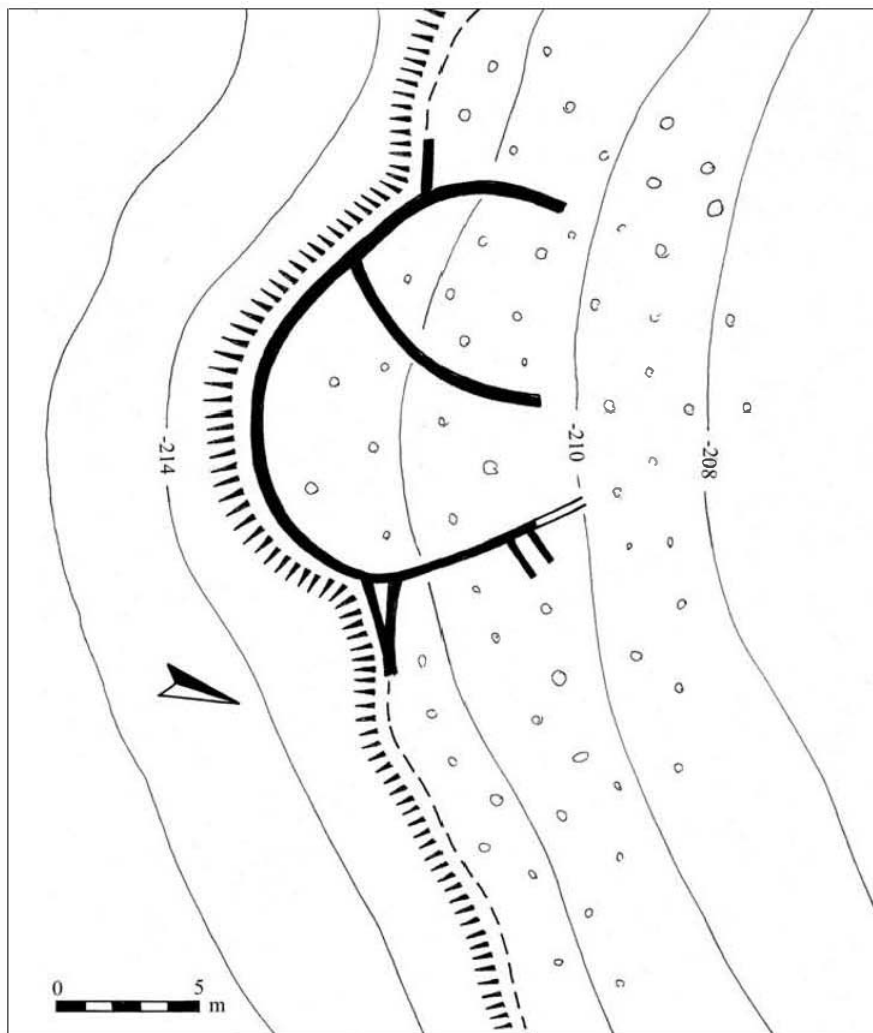
built of large stones, and has a curved dividing wall crossing it. Other walls protrude from the enclosure wall to the east and west. Inside the enclosure and in its vicinity are sherd and flint scatters.

Pottery: Neolithic (?) – 5%; Chalcolithic – 95%.

Flint: 96 items, see Bar 2014a: site 71.

Additional surveys: none.

Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 71.



189. Plan of Masu'a (8), 1993.

Site 95: 19-16/66/4

MASU'A (6)

Israel grid: 1962/1666

UTM grid: 7349/5535

Elevation: 210 m b.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosure and flint scatter

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

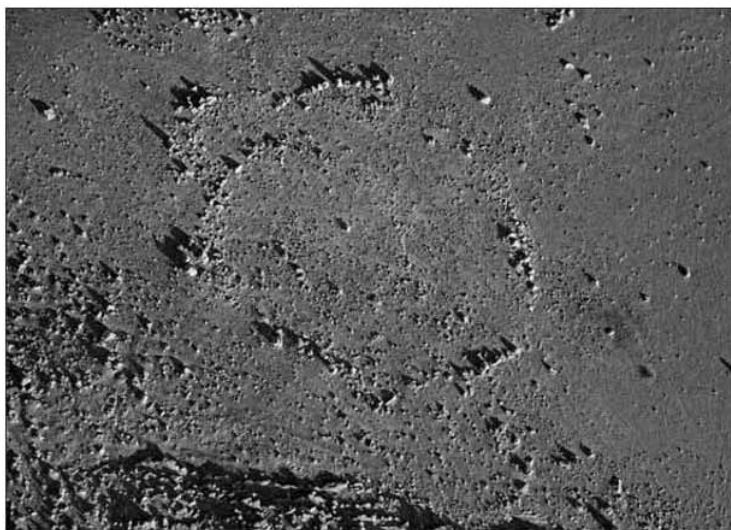
Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
2.8 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
700 m distant

Visits: Feb. 1993, 2003, 2014; 50 sherds

An enclosure in the southern part of Masu'a Valley, about 2.5 km east of the Sartaba.

There is an oval enclosure at the site, measuring 25-30 m, built of large stones. Apparently it was constructed in several phases, because in its western part are curved walls outside and parallel to the enclosure wall, forming a sort of opening. In the western part there is also a built entrance. About 50 m west of the enclosure is another small structure; and in the nearby ravine, through which a modern military road ascends, are the remains of structures built from medium-sized stones, seemingly belonging to the enclosure and having been a component of it.

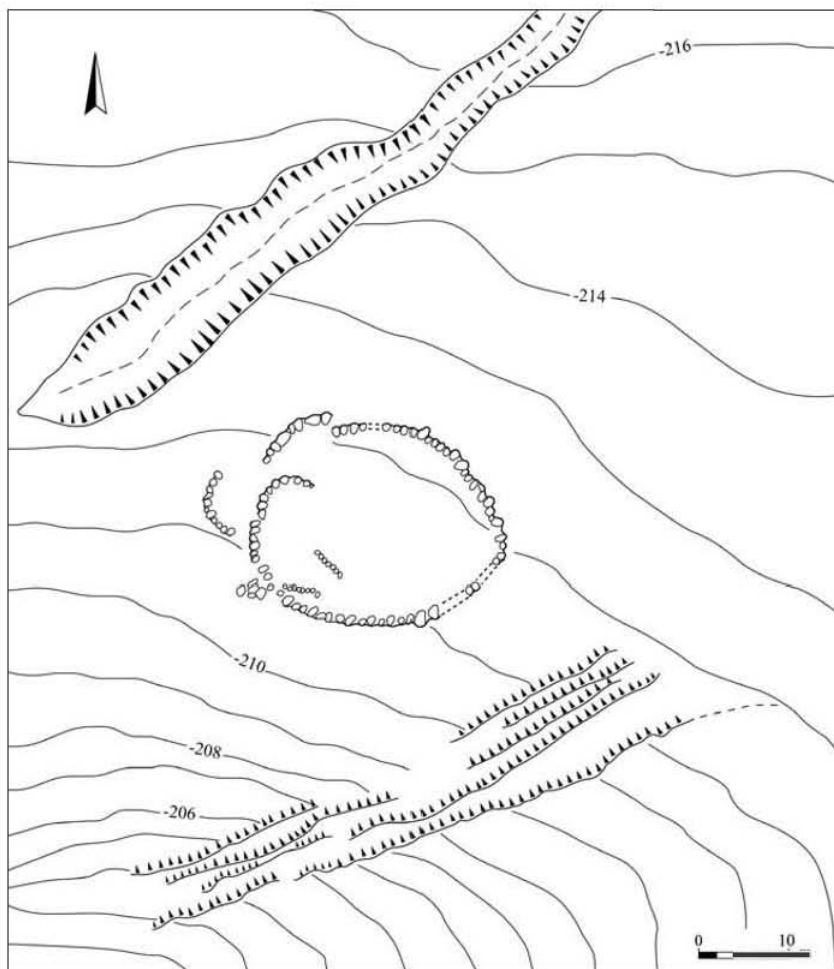


190. Aerial view of Masu'a (6), 2013 (A. Solomon).

Pottery: Iron I – 70%; Late Roman – 15%; Byzantine – 10%; Ottoman – 5%.

Flint: 41 items, including two scrapers and a perforator, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



191. Plan of Masu'a (6), 2003.



192. Pottery from Masu'a (6), all Iron I: 1. CP, lt brn; 2, 4. Jugs, brn; 3. Jar, brn.

Site 96: 19-16/56/1

MASU'A (9)

Israel grid: 1959/1666

UTM grid: 7345/5535

Elevation: 175 m b.s.l., 50 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: large and enclosures

Area: 12.5 dunams (1.25 ha)

Topography: valley

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Jeruzaliyeh (172),
3 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
1 km distant

Visits: Feb. 1993, Nov. 2014; 57 sherds

This site is composed of enclosures and structures in a deep narrow valley in the south-western part of the Masu'a Valley, about 2 km east of the Sartaba summit.

In the site are two main enclosures, one large and one small, with dwelling structures next to them:

1. The large enclosure (the south-western one), measures about 50×40 m, and is built of large stones. The enclosure is incomplete and its north-western part is missing. The wall has one or two rows of stones. Inside the enclosure are remains of walls and partitions.

On the slope above and west of this enclosure is an irregular wall, perhaps in the past another enclosure. Only its southern and western parts remain. West of it is a small round structure or courtyard.

2. North-east of the large enclosure, down the valley, is another round and smaller (25 m diameter) enclosure. This is also incomplete; its western part has been only partially preserved. In and around it are many walls of dwellings. East of this enclosure is a curved wall, which is parallel to the enclosure wall, terminating with a round structure. There is another similar round structure near this wall.
3. In the plain to the north-east were found remains of structures built of large stones, some of which are upright monoliths, perhaps marking the entrances of structures.

This large site perhaps served as a regional hub settlement; possibly being seasonal, but the good construction suggests a permanent settlement. Without excavation it is impossible to ascertain when the structures were built and the present arrangement of the place was finalized.